

The Way that can be told of is not an Unvarying Way;

The names that can be named are not unvarying names.

It was from the Nameless that Heaven and Earth sprang;

The named is but the mother that rears the ten thousand creatures, each after its kind.

Truly, "Only he that rides himself forever of

That which can be perceived is not the timeless That.

That which can be named is not the nameless One.

The source of heaven and earth is without form or substance.

Naming creates the

A path fit to travel

Is not a general path

A name fit for calling

Is not a generic name

"Nothing" names the origin of heaven and earth

"Being" names the mother of the myriad beings

And so, always be dispassionate

In

Tao

As for the road,

The Road that can be told is not the eternal Road.

As for names,

The name that can be named is not the eternal name.

The nameless is the beginning of the ten thousand things.

The named is the mother of the ten thousand things.

Therefore,

Tao is beyond words and beyond understanding.

Words may be used to speak of it, but they cannot contain it.

Tao existed before words and names, before heaven and earth, before the ten thousand things.

desire can see the Secret Essences";

He that has never rid himself of desire can see only the Outcomes.

These two things issued from the same mould, but nevertheless are different in name.

This "same mould" we can but call the Mystery,

Or rather the "Darker than any Mystery",

The Doorway whence issued all Secret Essences.

ten thousand things.

When desire is absent, the mystery is obvious.

When desire occurs, creation unfolds.

Mystery and creation arise from the same source.

The source is emptiness.

Void within void.

The realm of Tao.

order to see the mysteries

Always be passionate

In order to see the objectives

These two mean the same (when) emerging

While diverging in significance

The sameness tells of their mystery

Mystery leading to greater mystery (Is) the gateway to every mystery

ever desireless, one can see the mystery.

Those constantly with desires, will only see what they yearn for and seek.

These two spring from the same source.

They have different names; yet they are called the same.

That which is even more profound than the profound

The gateway to all mystery.

It is the unlimited father and mother of all limited things.

Therefore, to see beyond all boundaries to the subtle heart of things, dispense with names, with concepts, with expectations and ambitions and differences.

Tao and its many manifestations arise from the same source:

subtle wonder within mysterious darkness. This is the beginning of all understanding.

It is because every one under Heaven recognizes beauty as beauty,
That the idea of ugliness exists.
And equally if every one recognized virtue as virtue,
this would merely create fresh conceptions of wickedness.
For truly, Being and Not-being grow out of one another;
Difficult and easy complete one another.
Long and short test one another;
High and low determine one another.
Pitch and mode give harmony to one another.
Front and back give sequence to one another.

Judging beauty creates ugliness.
Defining good creates evil.
All and void arise together.
Hard and soft, long and short, high and low, sound and silence, now and then.
Opposites exist because of each other.

All under heaven know the beauty of things as beauty
So ugliness is already there
All know the good of things as the good
So the not-good is already there
And so being and nothingness beget each other
Difficult & easy complete each other
Lasting & brief define each other
High & low rely on each other
Tone & voice resonate with

Qualities
When everyone in the world can see beauty as beauty
Than ugliness comes into being.
When everyone knows good as good
Than evil comes into being.
Therefore having and not having arise together.
Difficult and easy complement each other.
Long and short contrast each other:
High and low rest upon each other;
Voice and sound harmonize each other;

When people find one thing beautiful, another consequently becomes ugly.
When one man is held up as good, another is judged deficient.
Similarly, being and non-being balance each other; difficult and easy define each other; long and short illustrate each other;
high and low rest upon each other; voice

the Sage relies on actionless activity,
Carries on wordless teaching,
But the myriad creatures are worked upon by him;
He does not disown them.
He rears them, but does not lay claim to them,
Controls them, but does not lean upon them,
Achieves his aim, but does not call attention to what he does;
And for the very reason that he does not call attention to what he does
He is not ejected from fruition of what he has done.

Therefore the sage acts by not-doing and teaches no-thought.
The ten thousand things arise and vanish without him.
He works without motive, indifferent to outcome.
Because there is no doer, his actions are timeless.

each other
Before & after follow each other
This is how wise ones abide without interfering with the work,
Practice without speaking their doctrine
A myriad beings emerge here, but without explanation
Are produced, but with no claims
Are developed, but with no expectations
Works are accomplished, but with no dwelling
Insofar as there is no dwelling

one another;
These are all constants.
Therefore the sage goes about doing nothing,
And practices the wordless teaching.
The ten thousand things rise and fall without cease,
But he does not begin them.
He acts on their behalf, yet not taking credit.
When he has done the work, then he forgets about it.
Therefore it lasts forever and it does not leave him.

and song meld into harmony; what is to come follows upon what has been.
The wise person acts without effort and teaches by quiet example.
He accepts things as they come, creates without possessing, nourishes without demanding, accomplishes without taking credit.
Because he constantly forgets himself, he is never forgotten.

If we stop looking for
"persons of superior
morality" (hsien) to put
in power,
There will be no more
jealousies among the
people.
If we cease to set store
by products that are
hard to get,
There will be no more
thieves.
If the people never see
such things as excite
desire,
Their hearts will
remain placid

Bestowing honor
breeds ambitions.
Hoarding treasure
invites thieves.
Displaying objects of
desire sows the seeds
of discontent.
Therefore the sage
governs
by emptying minds
and filling

Not exalting worthies
Keeps the people
from rivalry
Not prizing goods
which are hard to
obtain
Keeps the people
from acting like
thieves
Not displaying the
desirable
Keeps the peoples'
hearts from
confusion
This is how wise
ones approach
government
Emptying the hearts
(And)

Control
By not exalting the
worthy,
you prevent people
from competing.
By not valuing
treasures,
You prevent people
from acting like
thieves.
By not displaying
desirable things,
You prevent people
from confusion of the
heart.
Therefore the sage
rules
by emptying their
minds
and by

When praise is
lavished upon the
famous, the people
contend and compete
with one another.
When exotic goods
are traded and
treasured, the
compulsion to steal is
felt.
When desires are
constantly
stimulated, people
become disturbed
and confused.
Therefore, the wise
person sets

and undisturbed.
Therefore the Sage
rules
By emptying their
hearts
And filling their hearts?
Weakening their
intelligence
And toughening their
sinews
Ever striving to make
the people
knowledgeless and
desireless.
Indeed he sees to it that
if there be any who
have knowledge,
They dare not interfere.
Yet through his
actionless activity all
things are duly
regulated.

bellies,
by weakening wills
and strengthening
bones.
He extols the virtue
of desireless
unknowing
and keeps intellects
off balance.
When not-doing is
accomplished,
nothing remains
undone.

filling the bellies
Weakening the
ambitions
(And) strengthening
the bones
Always keeping the
people free of
sophistication, free of
desires
So that even the
clever ones will not
presume to meddle at
all
(Where) action does
not take action
There nothing is out
of order

stuffing their bellies,
by weakening their
ambitions
and strengthening
their bones.
He constantly causes
the people
to be without
knowledge and
desire,
If he can bring about
that clever people
will not try to
interfere,
than there is nothing
that will not be in
order.

an example by
emptying her mind,
opening her heart,
relaxing her
ambitions,
relinquishing her
desires, cultivating
her character.
having conquered her
own cunning and
cravings, she can't be
manipulated by
anyone.
Do by not-doing. Act
with non-action.
Allow order to arise
of itself.

The Way is like an empty vessel
That yet may be drawn from
Without ever needing to be filled.
It is bottomless; the very progenitor of all things in the world.
In it all sharpness is blunted,
All

Tao is hollow emptiness.
The substance of All, it is absent of substance.
Dimensionless Void, it is the source of the ten thousand things.
It blunts

The way (is) fluid, and yet in its practice
Somehow there is nothing in excess
So deep-
As if ancestor to the myriad beings
Blunt in its sharpness
Resolved in its

Properties of Tao
The Road is an empty vessel;
Yet when you use it, you never need to fill it again.
Deep and still, it seems to be
the source of the ten thousand things!
It

Tao is a whirling emptiness, yet when used it cannot be exhausted.
Out of this mysterious well flows everything in existence.
Blunting sharp edges, Untangling knots, Softening the glare, It

tangles untied,
All glare tempered,
All dust soothed.
It is like a deep pool that never dries.
Was it too the child of something else?
We cannot tell.
But as a substanceless image it existed before the Ancestor.

sharpness,
unravels entanglements,
diffuses brightness, merges with dust.
Dark, invisible, it only seems to be.
It is the child of no-thing
and the father of God.

tangles
Shaded in its glare
One with this world
So deep & clear
Seeming as though seeming to exist
We do not know whose child this is
(But) imagine it divinity's ancestor

blunts the sharpness, it unties the knot,
Soften the glare, and settles the dust.
Submerged, it seems perhaps to exist.
We do not know whose child it is.
It seems to be the forefather of the gods.

evolves us all and makes the whole world one.
Something is there, hidden and deep!
But I do not know whose child it is - It came even before God.

Heaven and Earth are
ruthless;
To them the Ten
Thousand things are
but as straw dogs.
The Sage too is
ruthless;
To him the people
are but as straw dogs.
Yet Heaven and
Earth and all that lies
between
Is

The realm of heaven
and earth is
indifferent to the
myriad creatures.
They appear as straw
dogs.
The sage is
indifferent to the
multitudes of men.
They appear as

Heaven & earth are
not compassionate
Treating the myriad
beings as straw dogs
Wise ones are not
compassionate
Regarding the
hundred families as
straw dogs
The space between
heaven & earth
How

Nature
Heaven and Earth are
impartial;
They regard the ten
thousand things as
straw dogs.
The wise are
impartial;
He regards the
common people as
straw dogs.
The space between
heaven and Earth -

Heaven and Earth are
not sentimental; they
regard all things as
dispensable.
The sage isn't
sentimental, either;
He views all forms as
ephemeral and
transitional.
Tao is like a bellows:
empty but
inexhaustible.

like a bellows
In that it is empty,
but gives a supply
that never fails.
Work it, and more
comes out.
Whereas the force of
words is soon spent.
Far better is it to keep
what is in the heart.

straw dogs.
The realm of heaven
and earth is like a
bellows,
both empty and full.
Moving, it brings
forth, endlessly.
More words, less
understanding.
Hold fast to the core.

this is like bellows &
flutes!
Empty, yet never
exhausted
(When) moved then
more is produced
Lots of words adds
up to exhaustion,
(This is) never as
good as holding the
center

Is it not like a
bellows?.
It is empty but not
depleted;
Move it and more
[always] comes out.
Much learning means
frequent exhausting.
That is not so good as
holding on to the
mean.

The more you move
it the more it makes.
Too much talk about
it evaporates your
understanding,
though. Simply stay
at the center of the
circle.

The Valley Spirit
never dies.

It is named the
Mysterious Female.

And the doorway of
the Mysterious
Female

Is the base from

The urge of creation
is ceaseless.

It is called the Dark
Mother.

The womb of the
Dark Mother

The spirit of the
valley does not die

It may be known as
the mysterious
feminine

The gateway of the
mysterious

The heart

The valley spirit
never dies;

We call it female, the
primal mother.

The gate of the
mysterious female

We call

The heart of Tao is
immortal, the
mysterious fertile
mother of us all,
of heaven and earth,

which Heaven and
Earth sprang.

It is there within us
all the while;

Draw upon it as you
will, it never runs
dry.

is the ground of
heaven and earth.

Timeless,
imperceptible,

it continues
ever-present.

Endless use does not
touch it.

feminine

May be known as the
source of heaven and
earth

Endless, continuous,
seeming to exist

To practice this is not
effort

it the root of Heaven
and Earth.

It is like a everlasting
veil, barely seen.

In being used; it is
not exhausted.

of every thing and
not-thing.

Invisible yet ever
present, you can use
it forever without
using it up.

Heaven is eternal, the Earth everlasting. How come they to be so? It is because they do not foster their own lives; That is why they live so long. Therefore the Sage Puts himself	The realm of heaven and earth is everlasting. Why is it everlasting? Because it is not conscious of itself. Having no thought of being,	Heaven is eternal, earth endures The reason why heaven & earth can continue and endure is this: That their lives are not their own In this way (they) can go on living This	Self Heaven endures; Earth last a long time. The reason why Heaven endures And Earth last a long time, Is that they do not live for themselves, Therefore they can long endure. Therefore the sage puts himself	Heaven is eternal, earth everlasting. They endure this way because they do not live for themselves. In the same way, the wise person
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in the background; but is always to the fore. Remains outside; but is always there. Is it not just because he does not strive for any personal end That all his personal ends are fulfilled?	it never is not. Like this, the sage forgets himself so is always present. Without self-concern, the self is eternal. When self-interest subsides, fulfillment happens.	is why wise ones put themselves last And yet (their) being advances Exclude themselves And yet (their) being persists Is it not because they have no self-interest? Thus (they) can fulfill their self-interests	in the background, Yet finds himself in the foreground. Puts selfconcern out of [his mind], Yet finds that his selfconcern is preserved. It is not that he has no self-interest, That he is therefore able to attain fulfillment.	puts himself last, and thereby finds himself first; Holds himself outside, and thereby remains at the center; Abandons himself, and is thereby fulfilled.
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The highest good is like that of water.

The goodness of is that it benefits the ten thousand creatures;

Yet itself does not scramble,

But is content with the places that all men disdain.

It is this makes water so near to the Way.

And if men think the ground the best place

Supreme virtue is like water.

It nourishes the ten thousand things without effort

and flows in places men shun.

It is like Tao.

Stand on solid ground.

Go deep into the heart.

The highest good is like water

Water's goodness benefits the myriad beings

And yet does not strive

Dwells in places which everyone else regards with contempt

And in this way is close to the way

In dwelling the good is place

In mind the good

Intimacy

The highest good is like water.

Water give life to the ten thousand things and yet does not compete with them.

It flows in places that the mass of people detest

and therefore is it close to the Way

In dwelling, the good thing is the land.

In the mind, the good

The highest good is like water which benefits all things and contends with none. it flows in low places that others disdain and thus it is close to the Tao.

In living, choose your ground well.

for building a house upon,

If among thoughts they value those that are profound,

If in friendship they value gentleness,

In words, truth; in government, good order;

In deeds, effectiveness; in actions, timeliness -

In each case it is because they prefer what does not lead to strife,

And therefore does not go amiss.

Speak only what is true.

In friendship, be kind.

In governing, be just.

In enterprise, be able.

In action, watch the timing.

Do not contend with nature and nothing will go wrong.

is depth

In relations the good is compassion

In speech the good is sincerity

In government the good is organization

In business the good is competence

In movement the good is timing

It is only when there is no contention

That there then is no resentment

thing is depth.

In giving, the good thing is being like Heaven.

In speaking, the good thing is sincerity.

In ruling, the good thing is order.

In affairs, the good thing is ability.

In action, the good thing is timeliness.

It is only because it does not compete, that therefore it is without fault.

In thought, stay deep in the heart. In relationships, be generous. In speaking, hold to the truth.

In leadership, be organized. In work, do your best. In action, be timely.

If you compete with no one, no one can compete with you.

Stretch a bow to the
very full,
And you will wish
you had stopped in
time;
Temper a sword-edge
to its very sharpest,
And you will find it
soon grows dull.
When bronze

An over-filled cup is
difficult to carry.
An over-sharp point
is easily broken.
Fill your house with
gold and jade
and it cannot

To maintain but then
overdo something
Is not as good as
one's showing
restraint
To rough out but then
(over)hone
something
Does not help hold
(the edge) long
(When) coins and
jade

Hubris
To hold it upright
and fill it to the brim,
is not so good as
stopping in time.
When you pound it
out and oversharpen
the blade,
the edge will soon
blunt.
When gold and

Filling to fullness is
not as good as
stopping at the right
moment.
Oversharpening a
blade causes its edge
to be lost.
Line your home with
treasures and you
won't be

and jade fill your
hall.
It can no longer be
guarded.
Wealth and place
breed insolence.
That brings ruin in its
train.
When your work is
done, then withdraw!
Such is Heaven's
Way.

be protected.
Become puffed with
pride
and disaster will
follow.
Do only what needs
doing then forget it.
This is the way of
heaven.

fill the hall
Nobody can defend
this
(Being) wealthy &
honored and then
being proud
The natural
consequence is one's
own misfortune
(When) the work
succeeds a body
retires
Keeping to heaven's
path

jade fills your rooms,
You will never be
able to protect it.
Arrogance and pride
with wealth and
titles,
bring on their own
disaster.
Retire when the work
is done,
Such is the way of
Heaven.

able to defend it.
Amass possessions,
establish positions,
display your pride:
Soon enough disaster
drives you to your
knees.
This is the way of
heaven: do your
work, then quietly
step back.

Can you keep the unquiet physical-soul from straying, Hold fast to the Unity, and never quit it? Can you, when concentrating your breath, Make it soft like that of a little child? Can you wipe and cleanse your vision of the Mystery till all is without blur? Can you love the people and rule the land, Yet remain unknown? Can you	While maintaining a body can you become One? While breathing the force of life can you be innocent as a babe? While polishing the dark mirror can you be without dust? While loving and ruling the people can you	(Are) shaping a soul & embracing union Possible without separation? (Are) concentrating the breath & attaining responsiveness Possible (as a) newborn child? (Are) cleansing & clearing the mystery's vision Possible without a stain? (Are) caring for people & ruling a realm Possible without interfering?	Love In nourishing the soul and embracing the One, Can you do it without letting them leave? In concentrating your breath and making it soft, Can you make it like that of a newborn babe? In cultivating and cleaning your profound vision, Can you do it so that you stay without stain? In loving the people and giving life to the country,	Can you marry your spirit and body to the oneness and never depart from it? Can you ride your breath until your entire being is as supple as the body of an infant? Can you cleanse your inner vision until you see heaven in every direction? Can you love the people and govern them without conniving and
in opening and shutting the heavenly gates play always the female part? Can your mind penetrate every corner of the land, But you yourself never interfere? Rear them, then, feed them, Rear them, but do not lay claim to them. Control them, but never lean upon them; Be chief among them, but do not manage them. This is called the Mysterious Power.	refrain from action? While coming and going from heaven can you be passive as a woman? Understanding all things can you abide in unknowing? Give birth and nurture. Create without claim. Lead without taking command. This is supreme virtue.	& closing the gates of heaven Possible playing the woman? (Are) clarifying & simplifying the four directions Possible without knowledge? Create things & care for them Create but do not possess Act but do not expect Lead but do not rule These may be called "mystical powers"	without cleverness? In opening and closing the gates of Heaven, Can you play the role of woman? In understanding and being open to all within the four reaches, Can you do it without using knowledge? Give birth to them and nourish them, Give birth to them, but don't try to own them, Help them to grow, but don't rule them, This is called the Profound Virtue.	manipulating? Can you bear heaven's children in all that you do and are? Can you give the wisdom of your heart precedence over the learning of your head? Giving birth, nourishing life, shaping things without possessing them, serving without expectation of reward, leading without dominating: These are the profound virtues of nature, and of nature's best things.

We put thirty spokes together and call it a wheel; But it is on the space where there is nothing That the usefulness of the wheel depends. We turn clay to make a vessel; But it is on the space where there is nothing That the usefulness	Thirty spokes of the wheel converge to define a hole. Clay is molded into pots to shape emptiness. Walls are hammered into	Thirty spokes converge in one hub Then depending upon what does not exist is the vehicle's usefulness Mold clay in order to produce a vessel Then depending upon what does not exist is the vessel's usefulness Cut	Wealth and worth Thirty spokes unite in the wheel's hub; It is precisely where there is nothing, that makes the wheel so useful. We shape and fire clay into a vessel; It is precisely the space within that makes the	Thirty spokes meet at a hollowed-out hub; the wheel won't work without its hole. A vessel is moulded from solid clay; its inner emptiness makes it useful. To make
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of the vessel depends. We pierce doors and windows to make a house; And it is on these spaces where there is nothing That the usefulness of the house depends. Therefore just as we take advantage of what is, We should recognize the usefulness of what is not.	rooms to enclosed space. Windows are cut into walls to frame absence. Though things may have value, without no-thing they are useless.	out doors and windows in order to make a dwelling Then depending upon what does not exist is the dwelling's usefulness Thus, the existence of something serves to make value The lack of something serves to make utility	clay pots so useful. We chisel out the doors and windows for a room; It is precisely in these empty spaces that makes the room so useful. Therefore benefit comes from what is there; Usefulness comes from what is not there.	a room, you have to cut doors and windows; without openings, a place isn't livable. To make use of what is here, you must make use of what is not.
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The fives colours confuse the eye, The fives sounds dull the ear, The five tastes spoil the palate. Excess of hunting and chasing Makes minds go	The five colors confuse the eye. The five tones deaden the ear. The five flavors dull the palette. Racing and hunting madden the	The five colors will make the human eye blind The five tones will make the human ear deaf The five flavors will make the human palate jaded Racing for speed and hunting for sport Will make	Distraction The five colors causes one's eyes to become blind. Racing horses and hunting causes one's mind to go mad. Goods that are hard to obtain, pose an obstacle to one's travels. The five flavors confuses one's palate. The five tones causes one's ears to go deaf. Therefore, in	The five colours blind the eye. The five tones deafen the ear. The five flavours overwhelm the palate. Fancy things get in the way of one's growth.
mad. Products that are hard to get Impede their owner's movements. Therefore the Sage Considers the belly not the eye. Truly, "he rejects that but takes this".	mind. Valuable goods hinder movement. Therefore the sage is guided by his gut, not his senses. He attends to one and ignores the other.	the human heart go mad Goods which are hard to obtain Will bring human progress obstruction This is why wise ones Regard the belly instead of regarding the sight And so dismiss That to choose This	the government of the sage: He is for the belly and not for the eyes. Thus he rejects that and takes this. The five colors green, red, yellow, white and black The five flavors sweet, bitter, salty, sour and pungent The five tones C, D, E, G and A	Racing here and there, hunting for this and that - Good ways to madden your mind, that's all. Relinquish what is without. Cultivate what is within. Live for your center, not your senses.

Favour and disgrace goad as it were to madness; High rank hurts keenly as our bodies hurt." What does it mean to say that favour and disgrace goad as it were to madness? It means that when a ruler's subjects get it they turn distraught, When they lose it they turn distraught. That is what is meant to be saying favour and disgrace goad as it were to madness. What does it mean to say that high rank hurts keenly as	Receive honor with dismay. Accept misfortune gratefully. Why receive honor with dismay? Honor and dishonor cause the same disturbance. With honor comes the fear of disgrace. With disgrace comes anxiety and dread. Why accept misfortune gratefully? Misfortune weakens	Favor & disgrace are equally frightening Exaltation and big trouble are the same as oneself Why say that favor & disgrace are equally frightening Favor sets up a downfall To get it is the same as a warning To lose it is the same as a warning Which says that favor & disgrace are equally frightening Why say that exaltation and big trouble are the same as oneself? This	Anxiety Regard favor and disgrace with alarm. Respect great distress as you do your own person. What do I mean when I say "Regard favor and disgrace with alarm?" Favor is inferior. If you get it - be alarmed! If you lose it - be alarmed! That is what I mean when I say "Regard favor and disgrace with alarm." What do I mean when I say	Favour and disgrace are equally problematic. Hope and fear are phantoms of the body. What does it mean the "favour and disgrace are equally problematic"? Favour lifts you up; disgrace knocks you down. Either one depends on the opinions of others and causes you to depart from your center. What does it mean that "hope and fear are phantoms of the body"?
our bodies hurt? The only reason that we suffer hurt is that we have bodies; If we had no bodies, how could we suffer? Therefore we may accept the saying: "He who in dealing with the empire regards his high rank As through it were his body is the best person to be entrusted with rules; He who in dealing with the empire loves his subjects as one should love one's body	the bond to body and self. Without a separate self, what misfortune is possible? See misfortune as a condition of separation, and you will become whole. See the world as your body, and all will be delivered unto you.	is the reason that we have big troubles: Assuming that we are selves As long as we are not selves What troubles do we have? And so, to respect & regard as oneself the workings of the world Is the same as deserving to inhabit the world To love & regard as oneself the workings of the world Is the same as deserving to be steward to the world	distress as you do your own person?" The reason that I have great distress Is that I have a body Without a body, what distress would I have? Therefore, to one who values acting for himself over acting on behalf of the world, you can entrust the world. And to one who in being parsimonious Regards his person as equal to the world, you can turn over the world.	When you regard your body as your self, hope and fear have real power over you. If you abandon the notion of body as self, hope and fear cannot touch you. Know the universe as your self, and you can live absolutely anywhere in comfort. Love the world as your self, and you'll be able to care for it properly.

Because the eye gazes but can catch no glimpse of it, It is called elusive. Because the ear listens but cannot hear it, It is called the rarefied. Because the hand feels for it but cannot find it, It is called the infinitesimal. These three, because they cannot be further scrutinized, Blend into one, Its rising brings no light; Its sinking, no darkness. Endless the series of things without name	Searching, we cannot see it. We call it ephemeral. Straining, we cannot hear it. We call it ethereal. Reaching, we cannot grasp it. We call it intangible. These three are often confused because they are the same. The One is not bright above and	Looking for things not seen Descriptions will tell of "the invisible" Listening for things not heard Descriptions will tell of "the inaudible" Reaching for things not grasped Descriptions will tell of "the intangible" These three do not allow complete investigation And so are confused and considered as one What height is not bright What depth is not dark An unbroken continuity does not permit description - A return home	The continuity of Tao We look at it, but do not see it; We name this "the minute." We listen to it, but do not hear it; We name this "the rarified." We touch it, but do not hold it; We name this "the level and smooth." These three cannot be examined to the limit. Thus they are merged as one. One - there is nothing more encompassing above it, and nothing smaller below it.	Looked at but not seen, listened to but not heard, grasped for but not held, formless, soundless, intangible: the Tao resists analysis and defies comprehension. Its rising is not about light, its setting not a matter of darkness. Unnameable, unending, emerging continually, and continually pouring back into nothingness, It is formless form, unseeable image, elusive, evasive unimaginable mystery.
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the way back to where there is nothing. They are called shapeless shapes; Forms without form; Are called vague semblance. Go towards them, and you can see no front; Go after them, and you see no rear. Yet by seizing on the Way that was You can ride the things that are now. For to know what once there was, in the Beginning, This is called the essence of the Way.	dark below. Transparent, it moves in and out of nothing. Its form has no shape. Its image has no substance. It is indistinct, elusive. Nothing to face, nothing to follow. Hold to the timeless Tao. Abide in the present. Now is the ancient beginning.	to non existence And so this is called the form of the formless The image of nothingness It is called elusive & obscure When it is met its head is not seen When it is followed its end is not seen To grasp the path of the ancients Is the way to master present existence The capacity to comprehend the ancient beginnings May be called the clue* to the way	Boundless, formless! It cannot be named, and returns to the state of no-thing. This is called the formless form, The substanceless image. This is called the subtle and indistinct. Follow it and you won't see it back; Greet it and you won't see its head. Hold on to the Way of the present - To manage the things of the present, And know the ancient beginning.	Confront it, and you won't see its face. Follow it and you can't find an end. Perceive its ancient subtle heart, however, and you become master of the moment. Know what came before time, and the beginning of wisdom is yours.
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Of old those that were the best officers of Court

Had inner natures subtle, abstruse, mysterious, penetrating,

Too deep to be understood.

And because such men could not be understood

I can but tell of them as they appeared to the world:

Circumspect they seemed, like one who in winter crosses a stream,

Watchful, as one who must meet danger on every side.

Ceremonious, as one who pays a visit;

Yet yielding, as ice when it begins to melt.

Blank, as a piece of uncarved wood;

The old masters were deep, unfathomable, profound beyond understanding.

Because they were unfathomable

we can only describe their demeanor.

Cautious, as if crossing an icy stream.

Alert, as if sensing danger.

Respectful, like visiting guests.

Yielding, like melting ice.

Simple, like uncarved

The ancients who had skill at practicing the way

Were subtle & mysterious, profound & penetrating

A depth not easy to fathom

Inasmuch as they were not easy to fathom

It is thus an effort to construct their appearance

So ready-

As if fording a stream in winter

So vigilant-

As if wary of (all) four neighbors

So dignified-

As though they were guests

So relenting-

Like ice which is about to melt

So artless-

The Saints

The one who was skilled at practicing Tao in antiquity, was subtle, mysterious, profound, and penetratingly wise.

His depth cannot be known.

It is only because he cannot be known,

That therefore, were I forced to describe him, I'd say:

Hesitant was he!,

Like someone crossing a winter stream.

Undecided was he!,

As though he was in fear of neighbors on all four sides.

Solemn and polite was he,

Like a visiting guest.

Scattered and dispelled was he!

Like ice

A sage is subtle, intuitive, penetrating, profound. His depths are mysterious and unfathomable.

The best one can do is describe his appearance: The sage is alert as a person crossing a winter stream; as circumspect as a person with neighbours on all four sides; as respectful as a thoughtful guest;

as yielding as melting ice; as simple as uncarved wood; as open as a valley; as chaotic as a

hills.

Murky, as a troubled stream —

(Tranquil, as the vast reaches of the sea,

Drifting as the wind with no stop.)

Which of you an assume such murkiness,

To become in the end still and clear?

Which of you can make yourself insert,

To become in the end full of life and stir?

Those who possess this Tao do not try to fill themselves to the brim,

And because they do not try to fill themselves to the brim,

They are like a garment that endures all wear and need never be renewed.

wood.

Open, like beckoning valleys.

Mysterious, like opaque pools.

Still the mind and the mud settles.

Do nothing and action comes of itself.

One who embraces Tao has no desire for fulfillment.

Not desiring fulfillment, he is finished with birth and death.

As though they were of unworked wood

So expansive-

As though they were watersheds

So intermingled-

As though they were turbid streams

Who is able, (as) a turbid stream, to become still and arrive by degrees at clarity?

Who is able, at peace, to become energetic and arrive by degrees at vitality?

Whoever preserves this path

Not longing for more than fullness

Only those not overfull

Can then stay obscure and not begin to be finished

that is about to melt.

Genuine unformed was he,

Like uncarved blocks of wood.

Merged, undifferentiated was he,

Opaque, like a muddy pool.

Broad and expansive was he,

Like a valley.

If you take a muddy pool and still it,

It gradually becomes clear.

If you bring something to rest in order to move it,

It gradually comes alive.

The one who preserves this Tao does not desire to become fulfilled.

Therefore he can wear out with no need to be renewed.

muddy torrent.

Why "chaotic as a muddy torrent"? Because clarity is learned by being patient in the heart of chaos. Tolerating disarray, remaining at rest, gradually one learns to allow muddy water to settle and proper responses to reveal themselves.

Those who aspire to Tao don't long for fulfillment. They selflessly allow the Tao to use and deplete them; They calmly allow the Tao to renew and complete them.

Push far enough towards the Void, Hold fast enough to Quietness, And of the ten thousand things none but can be worked on by you. I have beheld them, whither they go back. See, all things howsoever they flourish Return to the root from which they grew. This return to the root is called Quietness; Quietness is called submission to Fate; What has submitted to Fate has become part of the always so. To know the	Be completely empty. Be completely still. Witness the ten thousand things appear and vanish in one motion. Watch as they arise, linger, and return to the source—stillness. This is the way it is. It is called everlasting life. To witness the everlasting is to be awake. Not seeing the everlasting, one engages	Attaining perfect emptiness Remain patient & sincere The myriad beings arise as one Through this we observe the return Of beings in numberless multitudes Each coming home to its root Return to the root means serenity It may be called a return to a higher order Return to higher order speaks of	Trancending nature To reach Emptyness is what we mean by the extreme. To maintain tranquility is what we mean by the center Side by side, the ten thousand things rise and fall And by this I see their return. Things come forth in great numbers; Each one returns to its source. This is called tranquility, "Tranquility" - This mean to return to your fate. To return to your fate is to be constant.	Work toward emptiness and openness. Cultivate stillness. Breathe harmony. Become tranquility. As the ten thousand things rise and fall, rise and fall, just witness their return to the root. Everything that flourishes dissolves again into the source. To dissolve back into the source is to find peace. To find peace is to recover your true nature.
always-so is to be Illumined; Not to know it, means to go blindly to disaster. He who knows the always-so has room in him for everything; He who has room in him for everything is without prejudice. To be without prejudice is to be kingly; To be kingly is to be of heaven; To be of heaven is to be in Tao. Tao is forever and he that possess it, Though his body ceases, is not destroyed.	in blind action. Blind action leads to misfortune. Seeing the everlasting, one encompasses all. Encompassing all, one is impartial. Being impartial, one acts nobly. Acting nobly, one enters heaven. Entering heaven is to be one with Tao. Being one with Tao is to be everlasting. Though the body dies, nothing is disturbed.	the enduring To comprehend the enduring speaks of clarity To not comprehend the enduring Is to recklessly create suffering To comprehend the enduring (is) tolerance Tolerance becomes justice Justice becomes sovereignty Sovereignty becomes celestial The celestial becomes the path The path is then continuous	Not to know the constant is to be reckless and wild. If you're reckless and wild, Your actions will lead to misfortune. To know the constant, is to be open-minded. To be open-minded, is to be impartial. To be impartial, is to act royally. To be royal, is to be like Heaven. To be like Heaven is to be [one with] the Tao. If you are one with the Tao, You will suffer no harm till the end of your days,	To recover your true nature is to know the constancy of Tao. To know the constancy of Tao is insight. Insight opens your mind. An open mind leads to an open heart. Openheartedness leads to justice. Justice is an expression of divinity. Divinity is oneness with Tao. Oneness with Tao is freedom from harm, indescribable pleasure, eternal life.

Of the highest the people merely know that such a one exists; The next they draw near to and praise. The next they shrink from, intimidated; but revile. Truly, "It is by not believing people that you turn them	When a sage governs, people barely notice. Lesser rulers are praised and loved. Lesser still are feared and obeyed. The least are ridiculed	Great leaders' subordinates know of their existence Those next in order are loved and praised by them Those next in order are feared by them Those next in order are despised by them If trust	Rulers With the highest rulers - Those below simply know they exist. With those one step down - They love and praise them. With those one further step down - They fear them. And with those at the bottom - They	The best leader is one whose existence is barely known. Next best is one who is lived and praised. Next is one who is feared. Worst of all is a leader who is despised.
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into liars". But from the Sage it is so hard at any price to get a single word That when his task is accomplished, his work done, Throughout the country every one says: "It happened of its own accord".	and despised. Trust is earned by trusting. The sage uses words sparingly. His work is done without fanfare. People say: "It happened by itself."	lacks basis here There will be no trust here So step back- there is value to words Complete the task, follow through in the work The hundred families all will declare "(It was) our natural course!"	ridicule and insult them. Who does not trust enough will not be trusted. Hesitant and undecided! Like this is his respect for speaking. He completes his tasks and finishes his affairs Yet the common people say, "These things all happened by nature."	If you fail to trust people, they won't turn out to be trustworthy. Therefore, guide others by quietly relying on Tao. Then, when the work is done, the people can say, "We did this ourselves."
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It was when the Great Way declined That human kindness and morality arose; It was when intelligence and knowledge appeared That the Great Artifice began. It was when	When Tao is forgotten, charity and righteousness are born. When intelligence and knowledge are valued, duplicity and pretense soon	(Where) the great path is abandoned There appear benevolence & righteousness (When) the learned & clever emerge There appear great hypocrisies (When) the six bonds of	The loss of Tao Therefore When the great Tao is rejected, the virtues of humanity and righteousness arise. When knowledge and wisdom appear, It is then that the great hypocrisy begins. When the six relations are	When people lose sight of the Tao, codes of morality and justice are created. When cleverness and strategies are in use, hypocrites are
the six near ones were no longer at peace That there was talk of "dutiful sons"; Nor till fatherland was dark with strife Did we hear of "loyal slaves".	follow. When the family is discordant, love and duty are preached. When the country is in chaos, loyal patriots appear.	kinship are out of balance There appear filial piety and parental affection (When) countries & clans are in darkness & turmoil There appear loyalty & public service	not in harmony, Filial piety and compassion arise. And when the country is in chaos and confusion, it is then that Virtuous officials appear. The six relations Father, son, older brother, younger brother, husband and wife	everywhere. When families forego natural harmony, parents become pious and children become dutiful. When the nation is reigned by darkness, patriotic advisers abound.

Banish wisdom, discard knowledge, And the people will be benefited a hundredfold. Banish human kindness, discard morality, And the people will be dutiful and compassionate. Banish skill, discard profit, And thieves and robbers will disappear. If when these three things	Abandon holiness, renounce wisdom. It will be a hundred times better for everyone. Eliminate morality and benevolence. Love and empathy will naturally return. Give up	Cut out sanctimony, repudiate cleverness The people will profit a hundred times over Cut out benevolence, abandon righteousness The people return to filial piety & parental affection Cut out artfulness, abandon rewards (Then) robbers and thieves have nothing	Simplicity Give up sainthood, renounce knowledge, And the people will benefit a hundredfold. Eliminate humanity, renounce righteousness, And people will return to filial piety and compassion. Give up ingenuity, renounce profit, And bandits and thieves will disappear. These three sayings	Give up religiosity and knowledge, and the people will benefit a hundredfold. Discard morality and righteousness, and the people will return to natural love. Abandon shrewdness and profiteering, and there won't be any
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are done they find life too plain and unadorned, Then let them have accessories; Give them Simplicity to look at, the Uncarved Black to hold, Give them selflessness and fewness of desires. Banish learning, and there will be no more grieving.	cleverness and profit. Thieves and bandits will disappear. But those are outward lessons, not the core. Be simple. Be true. Cast off selfhood and desire.	to gain These three may help to improve the culture but (they) are not a foundation So let there be purpose to build on: Look to the ordinary & embrace original nature Diminish self-interest & have fewer desires	- Regarded as a text are yet not complete. Thus we must see to it That they have the following appended: Manifest plainness and embrace the genuine; Lessen selfinterest and make your desires few, Eliminate learning and have no undue concern.	robbers or thieves. These are external matters, however. What is most important is what happens within: look to what is pure; hold to what is simple; let go of self-interest; temper your desires.
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Between wei and o

What after all is the difference?

Can it be compared to the difference between good and bad?

The saying "what others avoid I too must avoid"

How false and superficial it is?

All men, indeed, are wreathed in smiles,

As though feasting after the Great Sacrifice,

As though going up to the Spring Carnival.

I alone am inert, like a child that has not yet given sign;

Like an infant that has not yet smiled.

I droop and drift, as though I belonged nowhere.

All men have

Between yes and no, is there really much difference?

Good and bad, are they so far apart?

Must I think as others think?

Alas, there would be no end to fear.

The multitudes are busy with feasts and celebrations.

In spring they climb towers and enjoy the view.

I alone am unmoved, like an infant too young to smile.

Others have

Cut out the academics & avoid the anxieties

The (ready) yes, alongside the (obsequious) yea

What is the distance or nearness between them?

(Even) the good, next to the bad,

What is the difference or likeness between them?

(That) that which the others hold in awe

Will not permit less than awe -

What nonsense! There will never be an end to this, ever!

Everyone (else) is resplendent & festive

As if feasting on great sacrifices

As if in springtime & climbing up towers

I alone am unmoved here, one yet to give a sign

Like a newborn infant, one yet

Oneness

Agreement and angry rejection;

How great is the difference between them?

Beautiful and ugly;

What is it like - the difference between them?

The one who is feared by others;

Must I also fear what others fear?

Wild, unrestrained. It will ever come to an end.

The multitudes are peaceful and happy,

Like climbing a terrace in springtime,

enjoying the sacrificial feast of the ox.

But I alone am calm and quiet -

not yet having given any sign.

Be done with knowing and your worries will disappear. How much difference is there between yes and no? How much distinction between good and evil?

Fearing what others fear, admiring what they admire-nonsense.

Conventional people are jolly and reckless, feasting on worldly things and carrying on as though every day were the beginning of spring. I alone remain uncommitted, like an infant who hasn't yet smiled: lost, quietly drifting, unattached to ideas and places and things.

enough and to spare;

I alone seem to have lost everything.

Mine is indeed the mind of a very idiot,

So dull am I.

The world is full of people that shine;

I alone am dark.

They look lively and self-assured;

I alone depressed.

(I seem unsettled as the ocean;

Blown adrift, never brought to a stop.)

All men can be put to some use;

I alone am intractable and boorish.

But wherein I most am different from men

Is that I prize no sustenance that comes not from the Mother's breast.

more than enough.

I alone have nothing.

My mind is that of a fool—empty.

Others are clear and bright.

I alone am nebulous and dim.

Others are alert and clever.

I alone am withdrawn, adrift in the ocean,

directionless as swirling wind.

Everyone else has purpose.

I alone am stubborn and untamed.

I am different.

to smile

So worn & weary, as one with no home to come home to

Everyone (else) takes more than enough

While I alone seem forsaken

With only my simpleton's mind!

So muddled & confused

The common folk are bright & sunny

I alone am in chaos & gloom

The common folk are alert & sharp

I alone am torpid & blunt

So placid- in this like the sea

So restless a wind- as if never to stop

Everyone else has purpose

While I alone am wayward, like a rustic

I alone am other than the others

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people hoard more than they need, but I possess nothing at all, know nothing at all, understand nothing at all.

They are bright; I am dark. They are sharp; I am dull. Like the sea, I am calm and indifferent. Like the wind I have no particular direction.

Everyone else takes his place and does his job; I alone remain wild and natural and free. I am different from others; my sustenance comes directly from the Mother.

Such the scope of the All-pervading Power. That it alone can act through the Way. For the Way is a thing impalpable, incommensurable. Incommensurable, impalpable. Yet latent in it are forms; Impalpable, incommensurable Yet within it are entities. Shadowy it is and	Supreme virtue is to abide in Tao alone. Tao is elusive and empty— oh yes, utterly empty and elusive— yet within it dreamlike images arise. Oh yes, it is indistinct and nebulous, but within it shadows take	The bearing of true character Is simply to follow a true path If the way is regarded as an entity It is only elusive, only vague So vague & so elusive (Yet) at its center there is shape So elusive & so vague (Yet) at its center there are beings So arcane	Expressions of Tao The character of great Virtue Follows only from the Way. As for the nature of the Way - It is without shape or form. Formless! Shapeless! Inside there are images. Shapeless! Formless! Inside there are things. Hidden! Obscure! Inside are there essences. These essences are	The greatest virtue is to follow Tao, and only Tao. You might say, "But Tao is illusive! Evasive! Mysterious! Dark! How can one follow that?" By following this: Out of silent subtle mystery emerge images. These images coalesce into forms. Within each form is contained the seed and essence of life.
dim; Yet within it there is a force, Is none the less efficacious. From the times of old till now Its charge has not departed But cheers onward the many warriors. How do I know that the many warriors are so? Through this.	form. Oh yes, it is mysterious and dark, but within it appearances originate. The origin of creation is the real. Its manifestations are unceasing. This can be witnessed. How do I witness the origin of creation? By looking!	& so shadowy (Yet) at its center there is seed This seed is profoundly real At its center there is truth From the present back into antiquity Its meaning does not fade Through this is seen a common ancestry How do we know that the common ancestry's shape is thus? By This	very real, Inside them is the proof. From the present back to the past, its name has never gone away. It is by this that we comply with the father of the multitude of things. How do I know the father of the multitude is so? By this.	Thus do all things emerge and expand out of darkness and emptiness. Because its essence is real and evident in the origins of all things, the name of the Tao has survived since the beginning of time. How can I know the circumstances of the origins of all things? Exactly by this phenomenon.

"To remain whole, be twisted!" To become straight, let yourself be bent. To become full, be hollow. Be tattered, that you may be renewed. Those that have little, may get more, Those that have much, are but perplexed. Therefore the ; Sage Clasps the Primal Unity, Testing by it everything under heaven. He does not show himself; therefore he seen everywhere.	Surrender and become whole. Bend low and be straightened. Become empty and be filled. Burn out and be renewed. Having nothing, beauty is revealed. Having much, the way is hidden. The sage abides in One and thus is master of heaven and earth. Not being self-absorbed, his vision is clear.	The yielding becomes whole The bent becomes straight The hollow becomes replenished The worn becomes renewed The diminished becomes endowed The plentiful becomes doubtful This is why wise ones embrace unity Adopting nature as model Without self-display And thus clear Without self-righteousness And thus distinguished	Expressions of Tao Bent over, you will be preserved whole; When twisted, you will be upright; When hollowed out, you will be full; When Worn out, you will be renewed; When you have little, you will attain much; With much, you will be confused. Therefore the Sage embrace the One and in this way becomes shepherd of the World. He does not show himself off; Therefore he becomes prominent. He does not put himself on	Allow yourself to yield, and you can stay centered. Allow yourself to bend, and you will stay straight. Allow yourself to be empty, and you'll get filled up. Allow yourself to be exhausted, and you'll be renewed. Having little, you can receive much. Having much, you'll just become confused. Therefore the sage embraces the oneness and becomes a pattern for the
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is distinct. He does not boast of what he will do, therefore he succeeds. He is not proud of his work, and therefore it endures. He does not contend, And for that very reason no one under heaven can contend with him. So then we see that the ancient saying "To remain whole, be twisted!" was no idle word; For true wholeness can only be achieved by return.	Not asserting himself, his light shines forth. Not showing off, his merit is obvious. Not praising himself, praise is showered upon him. Not contending, nothing under heaven stands in his way. This ancient saying, "Surrender and become whole," is it empty words? Being whole means all things have returned to you.	having merit Without self-glorification And thus enduring It is only when there is no contending That none in the world can contend against them The ancient ones had reasons to claim "The accommodating becomes whole" Is this (just) empty talk now? (When) wholeness is real then one has come home	a display; Therefore he brightly shines. He does not brags about himself; Therefore he receives credit. He does not praise his own deeds; Therefore he can long endure. It is only because he does not compete, That therefore no one is able to compete with him. The so called "Bent over, you will be preserved whole" Of the the ancients was an expression that was really close to it! Truly "wholeness" will belong to him.	whole world. She doesn't display herself, so she becomes illuminated. She doesn't justify herself, so she becomes distinguished. She doesn't boast, so she is recognized. She doesn't claim credit, so she advances and endures. She doesn't contend, so no one can contend with her. "Yield and you can stay centered"- Is this saying meaningless? Stay whole, and all things return to you.
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To be always talks is against nature. For the same reason a hurricane never lasts a whole morning, Nor a rainstorm all day. Who is it that makes the wind and rain? It is Heaven-and Earth. And if even Heaven-and Earth cannot blow or pour for long, How much less in his utterance should man? Truly, if one uses the Way as one's instrument, The results will be like the Way; If one uses the "power" as instrument, The results	To speak a short time is the way of nature. High winds blow out before morning. Hard rain subsides in a day. What issues these? The realm of heaven and earth. If the realm of heaven and earth cannot maintain duration, what chance has man? This is why one embraces Tao. He who aligns	Sparing are the speeches from nature So the whirling winds do not last morning The storming rains do not last all day What is it producing these? Heaven and earth (If) even heaven and earth are unable to persist Then compare this (case) with humanity! And so to attend to affairs of the path: The path means an identity with the path	Acceptance and Contention To talk little, is the way of Nature. Fierce winds do not last all morning. Heavy rain does not last all day. Who makes these things! If even Heaven and Earth Cannot make these things last long, How much more is this true for man? Therefore one who devotes himself to	Nature is sparing with speech: a whirlwind doesn't last all morning; a rain shower doesn't last all day. What causes these? Heaven and earth.
will be like the "power". If one uses what is the reverse of the "power", The results will be the reverse of the "power". For to those who have conformed themselves to the Way, The Way readily lends its power. To those who have conformed themselves to the power, The power readily, lends more power. While to those who conform themselves to inefficacy, Inefficacy readily lends its ineffectiveness. "It is by not believing in people that you turn them into liars."	with Tao becomes one with Tao. He who aligns with virtue attains supreme virtue. He who fails to align with Tao is lost. He who aligns with Tao is received by Tao. He who aligns with virtue finds only virtue. He who has become lost is close to home. Faith comes to the faithful.	Character means an identity with character Failure means an identity with failure For those who identify with the path The path, in turn, readily* accepts them For those who identify with character Character, in turn, readily accepts them For those who identify with failure Failure, in turn, readily accepts them If truth has no basis here	Tao Is one with Tao. One who devotes himself to Virtue [and attainment] is one with Virtue. One who devotes himself to losing is one with that loss. To the one who is one with Virtue, Tao also gives Virtue. While for the one who is one with his loss, Tao also disregards him.	If heaven and earth can't make something famous endure, how could man? Concentrate on Tao and you'll experience Tao. Concentrate on power and you'll experience power. Concentrate on loss and you'll experience loss. If you won't trust, you won't be trusted.

'He who stands on tip-toe, does not stand firm; He who takes the longest strides, does not walk the fastest." He who does his own looking sees little, He who defines himself is not therefore distinct. He who boasts of what he will do succeeds in nothing; He who	He who stands on tiptoe is unsteady. He who strides too hard cannot go far. He who shines a light on himself is not enlightened. He who asserts himself is not distinguished. He who praises himself has	Those who stand on tiptoe do not stand (firmly) Those who stretch strides do not make progress Those who display themselves are less than clear Those who are self-righteous are less than distinguished Those who assert	Tumors One who boasts is not established. One who shows himself off does not become prominent. One who makes a show is not enlightened. One who brags about himself gets no credit; One who praises himself	A man who tiptoes can't stand. A man who straddles can't walk. A man who shows off can't shine. A man who boasts of his achievements has no merit. A
is proud of his work, achieves nothing that endures. Of these, from the standpoint of the Way, it is said: "Pass round superfluous dishes to those that have already had enough, And no creature but will reject them in disgust." That is why he that possesses Tao does not linger.	no merit. He who brags of his success will not last long. Observers of Tao see these as spoiled food and pointless action— shunned even by the myriad creatures. One who knows Tao does not abide them.	themselves lack merit Those who glorify themselves do not endure To someone on the path here These suggest excessive indulgence and irrelevant action Things somehow wrong to have So those who have the way do not linger	does not long endure. In the Way such things are called: "Extra food and redundant action." And with things - there are those who hate them therefore followers of the Tao does not dwell in them.	man who brags will not endure. To a person of Tao, these things are excess food and superfluous behaviour. Because nothing good can come of them, he doesn't indulge in them.

There was something
formless yet complete,

That existed before
heaven and earth;

Without sound, without
substance,

Dependent on nothing,
unchanging,

All pervading, unfailing.

One may think of it as the
mother of all things under
heaven.

Its true name we do not
know;

Were I forced to say to
what class of things it
belongs

I should call it Great (ta)

Now ta also means
passing on,

And passing on means
going Far Away,

And going far

Formless no-thing.

Precedent of heaven
and earth.

Timeless,
unchanging, solitary,
silent.

It is the mother of the
ten thousand things.

I do not know its
name.

I call it Tao.

If forced to describe
it,

I call it great.

Great implies vast
reaches.

Vast reaches implies
far away.

Far away

There was something in
chaos (yet) complete

Before heaven & earth
came to be

So silent, so remote

Standing alone without
change

Acting everywhere and
without limit

(It) may be regarded as
mother to (all) under
heaven

We do not know its
name

A word for it speaks of a
path

(If) pressed to develop
its name speak of
greatness

Greatness tells of
journeying on

Four infinities

There was something
mysteriously formed
out of chaos,

That was born before
Heaven and Earth.

Quiet en still! Pure
and deep!

It stands alone on its
own and does not
change.

It can be regarded as
the mother of Heaven
and Earth.

I do not yet know its
name.

I style it "The Way".

For lack of a better
word, I call it great.

Being great, it flows,
it flows far —

Something
mysterious and
perfect existed before
even heaven and
earth were born.
Silent, immeasurable,
standing alone and
unchanging, moving
without end or
exhaustion, it is the
mother of the known
and unknown
universe.

I don't know its
name, so I call it by
an alias: Tao. Forced
to describe it, I only
say, "It is great."

away means returning.

Thus just as Tao has "this
greatness" and as earth
has it and as heaven has it,

So may the ruler also have
it.

Thus "within the realm
there are four portions of
greatness",

And one belongs to the
king.

The ways of men are
conditioned by those of
earth.

The ways of earth, by
those of heaven.

The ways of heaven by
those of Tao, and the
ways of Tao by the
Self-so.

implies return.

Tao is great.

Heaven is great.

Earth is great.

Man, too, is great.

In the realm there are
four greats,

and a noble man is
one.

Man follows the way
of earth.

Earth follows the
way of heaven.

Heaven follows the
way of Tao.

Tao is the great Way.

far beyond

The far beyond tells of
coming back

In this way the way is
great

Heaven is great, earth is
great

And sovereignty, too, is
great

Between the horizons
are four (kinds of)
greatness

And sovereignty has its
place as one among
these

Humanity takes the earth
as law

The earth takes heaven
as law

Heaven takes the way as
law

away.

Having gone far, it
returns.

Tao is great;

Heaven is great;

Earth is great;

And the king is also
great."

These are the four
great powers

And the king occupies
one place among
them.

Man models himself
to the Earth.

Earth models itself on
Heaven.

Heaven models itself
on the Tao.

That which is great
continues. That
which continues goes
far. That which goes
far returns.

Therefore Tao is
great, heaven is
great, earth is great, a
person of Tao is
great. These are the
four greatnesses in
the universe.

A person of Tao
follows earth. Earth
follows Heaven.
Heaven follows Tao.
Tao follows its own
nature.

As the heavy must be
the foundation of the
light,
So quietness is lord
and master of
activity.
Truly, "A man of
consequence though
he travels all day
Will not let himself
be separated from his
baggage-wagon,
However magnificent
the view, he

Gravity is the ground
of lightness.
Stillness is the master
of unrest.
The sage can travel
all day,
yet never wander far
from the baggage
wagon.
Though splendor and
spectacle may

The heavy serves as
root to the light
Stillness serves as
master to haste
And so it is that a
noble one journeys
all day
Without leaving the
heavy supply wagon,
Although there are
splendid vistas,
Calmly staying

Calm
The heavy is the root
of the light;
Tranquility is the
master of agitation.
Therefore the
gentleman, traveling
all day,
does not lose sight of
his luggage carts,
Though there are
beautiful things to be
seen.
When he is safely
inside a walled-in
tavern

Heaviness is the root
of lightness.
Tranquility is the
master of agitation.
This is why the sage
travels all day
without ever losing
sight of her baggage.

sits quiet and
dispassionate".
How much less, then,
must be the lord of
ten thousand chariots
Allow himself to be
lighter than these he
rules!
If he is light, the
foundation is lost;
If he is active, the
lord and master is
lost.

beckon,
he remains unmoved,
indifferent.
Why should the lord
of ten thousand
chariots act lightly?
One who acts lightly
is not grounded.
One who is restless is
not his own master.

above it all
So how could the
lord of a myriad
chariots
Also conduct a
frivolous life under
heaven?
To be frivolous,
would then be to lose
the root
To be hasty would
then be to lose the
mastery

Only then does he
transcends all
concern.
How can the lord of
ten thousand chariots
Treat his own person
more lightly than the
whole land?
If you regard the
things too lightly
Then you lose your
roots.
If you are restless,
you lose your
control.

She may live in a
glorious palace, but
she isn't attached to
its pleasures.
Why should the lord
of ten thousand
chariots behave
lightly in the world?
One who acts lightly
loses her foundation.
One who becomes
agitated sacrifices her
mastery.

Perfect activity leaves no track behind it; Perfect speech is like a jade-worker whose tool leaves no mark. The perfect reckoner needs no counting-slips; The perfect door has neither bolt nor bar, Yet cannot be opened. The perfect knot needs neither rope nor twine, Yet cannot be united. Therefore the Sage Is all the time in the most perfect way helping men, He certainly does not turn his back on men; Is all the	A good walker leaves no tracks. A good speaker does not slip up. A good accountant needs no counter. A good doorsmith uses no bolts or locks yet none can open what he closes. A good binder uses no knots yet what he binds cannot be unraveled. The sage is good at saving souls and rejects no one.	The able wanderer leaves no trail (or) trace The able speaker is without fallacy (or) error The able reckoner does not use counting devices The best closure uses no barrier (or) bar And yet is not easily opened The best binding uses no cord (or) knot And yet is not easily loosened And so it is that wise ones Are ever so skilled at making the most of others That	Attention A good walker leaves no track behind; A good speaker makes no slips; A good reckoner needs no tally. A good closer of doors needs no bolt or lock, And yet no one can open it. Good binding of knots requires no rope or cord, Yet no one can loosen it. Therefore the sage is constantly good In taking care of all men	A good runner leaves no tracks; A good speaker makes no slips; A good planner doesn't have to scheme. The best lock has no bolt, and no one can open it. The best knot uses no rope, and no one can untie it. Thus the master is always good at saving people, and doesn't abandon anyone; Always good at saving things, and doesn't waste anything.
time in the most perfect way helping creatures, He certainly does not turn his back on creatures. This is called resorting to the Light. Truly, "the perfect man is the teacher of the imperfect; But the imperfect is the stock-in-trade of the perfect man". He who does not respect his teacher, He who does not take care of his stock-in-trade, Much learning through he may possess, is far astray.	He takes care of all things and abandons nothing. This is called "the way of awareness." The good man is the ignorant man's teacher. The ignorant man is the good man's lesson. To not honor the teacher and value the lesson— no matter how much wisdom one acquires— is to miss the mark. This is an essential secret.	no person is forsaken Are ever so skilled at making the most of situations That no situation is wasted This may be called "practical wisdom" And so the able one is the less than able one's teacher The less than able one is the able one's resource To not value one's teacher, to not care for one's resource, However "prudent" is greatly deluded This may be called a "tactical mystery"	Constantly good in taking care of things; And never rejects useful goods; This is called "Doubly bright". Therefore the good man is the teacher of the good And the bad man is the raw material for the good. Do not value one's teacher And do not cherish the raw goods- Though one had great knowledge, He would still be greatly confused.	This is known as "Following the light." What is a good man but a bad man's teacher? What is a bad man but a good man's charge? It doesn't matter how smart you are if you don't have the sense to honour your teachers and cherish your responsibilities. This is an essential teaching of Tao.

"He who knows the males, yet cleaves to what is female Because like a ravine, receiving all things under heaven," And being such a ravine He knows all the time a power that he never calls upon in vain. This is returning to the state of infancy. He who knows the white, (yet cleaves to the black Becomes the standard by which all things are tested; And being such a standard	Know the strength of the male, but keep to the role of the female. Be the river of the world. Being the river of the world, supreme virtue flows without end. Flowing without end, you are the timeless infant. Know the purity of light but maintain darkness. Be the model of the world. Being the model of the world, supreme virtue is constant.	Know the masculine (But) keep the feminine Serve as a stream to the world Serving as stream to the world Consistent character will not depart (But) return home again as the newborn child Know the bright (But) keep the dark Serve as a model to the world Serving as model to the world Consistent character will not falter (But) return home again as	Being female When you know the strength of man, Yet keep a woman's care! You will be the ravine of the country. When you are the ravine of the country, Your constant virtue will not leave. And when your constant virtue does not leave. You will return to the state of a little child. When you know the pure, Yet keep the soiled! You will be the valley of the country! When you are the valley of the country, Your constant virtue is complete.	To know the masculine and yet cleave to the feminine is to be the womb for the world. Being the womb for the world, never departing from the eternal power of Tao, you become as an infant once again: immortal. To know the bright and yet hold to the dull is to be an example for the world.
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errs, He returns to the Limitless. He who knows glory,) yet cleaves to ignominy Become like a valley that receives into it all things under heaven, And being such a valley He has all the time a power that suffices; He returns to the state of the Uncarved Block. Now when a block is sawed up it is made into implements; But when the Sage uses it, it becomes Chief of all Ministers.	virtue, you are the boundless realm. Be worthy of high honors, but keep to the role of the lowly. Be the valley of the world. Being the valley of the world, supreme virtue is fulfilled. Being fulfilled, you are the uncarved block. The uncarved block appears as separate things. The sage sees things as they are and rules the world. Great power does not divide.	unlimited Know the honored (But) keep the humble Serve as a valley to the world Serving as valley to the world Consistent character will then be enough A return journey home to original nature Original nature, cut up, is then made into artifacts Wise ones, using such things, Are then made into senior officials And so the greatest governing does the least dividing	complete, You will return to the state of uncarved wood. When you know the white, Yet keep the black. You will be the model for the country! And when you are the model for the country, Your constant virtue will not go astray, And when your constant virtue does not go astray, You will return to the condition without limit. When uncarved wood is cut up, It is turned into vessels; When the sage is used, He becomes Head of the Officials. Truly, great carving is done without splitting up.	Being the example for the world, not deviating from the everlasting power of Tao, you return to the infinite once again: limitless. To know honour and yet keep to humility is to be the valley for the world. Being the valley for the world, rich with the primal power of Tao, you return once again to simplicity, like uncarved wood. Allow Tao to carve you into a vessel for Tao. Then you can serve the world without mutilating it.
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Those that would gain what is under heaven by tampering with it - I have seen that they do not succeed. For that which is under heaven is like a holy vessel, dangerous to tamper with. Those that tamper with it, harm it. Those that grab	There are those who want to control the realm and make it more to their liking. They will never succeed. The realm of heaven and earth is perfect, a sacred vessel. It cannot be improved. He who tries to change it, destroys it	When taken by desire to take hold of nature and reconstruct things We notice that this (will) never reach closure The world is a spirit vessel Not suited to reconstruction at all Those who interfere spoil things Those who grab	Blindness For those who like to take control of the world and act on it - I see that with this they simply will not succeed. The world is a sacred vessel; It is not something that can be acted upon. Those who	If you try to grab hold of the world and do what you want with it, you won't succeed. The world is a vessel for spirit, and it wasn't made to be manipulated. Tamper with it and you'll spoil it.
at it, lose it. For among the creatures of the world some go in front, some follow; Some blow hot when others would be blowing cold. Some are feeling vigorous just when others are worn out. Therefore the Sage "discards the absolute, the all-inclusive, the extreme".	for himself. He who tries to hold it, loses all contact. It is natural for beings to sometimes lead, sometimes follow, sometimes breathe hot, sometimes blow cold. sometimes expand, sometimes decay, sometimes overcome, sometimes collapse. The sage therefore abandons pleasure, judgment and pride.	lose things And so the beings sometimes go ahead, sometimes follow Sometimes snort, sometimes puff Sometimes are fit, sometimes are feeble Sometimes hold up, sometimes break down This is why wise ones avoid the extremes Avoid the superfluous Avoid the extravagant	act on it, destroy it. Those who hold on it, lose it. With things - some go forward, others follow; Some are hot - others submissive and weak; Some rise up - while others fall down; Therefore the Sage avoids extremes, Excesses, and extravagance.	Hold it, and you'll lose it. With Tao, sometimes you move ahead and sometimes you stay back; Sometimes you work hard and sometimes you rest; Sometimes you're strong and sometimes you're weak; Sometimes you're up; sometimes you're down. The sage remains sensitive, avoiding extremes, avoiding extravagance, avoiding excess.

He who by Tao purposes to help a ruler of men Will oppose all conquest by force of arms; For such things are wont to rebound. Where armies are, thorn and brambles grow. The raising of a great host Is followed by a year of dearth. Therefore a good general effects his purpose and then stops; he does not take further advantage of his victory. Fulfils —	When counseling rulers, observers of Tao do not advise force. This is certain to bring consequences. Where great armies have passed, thorn bushes thrive. Famine follows in the wake of war. A good ruler does only what is necessary to achieve results. He does not abuse position. Achieve results, but do	Those who use the way to help with human government Do not use arms (or) force on the world Such efforts tend to recoil (In) a place where an army has camped Thorns and brambles grow now A great army's aftermath is sure to bring bad harvests Those who are competent succeed and then stop	Violence Those which advise their ruler in the way of Tao, Do not use weapons to commit violence in the world. Such deeds easily rebounds. In places where armies are stationed, Thorns and brambles will grow. The good general achieves his result and that is all; He does not use the occasion to seize strength from it. He achieves his result, but does not become arrogant. He achieves his	Those who wish to use Tao to influence others don't rely on force or weapons or military strategies. Force rebounds. Weapons turn on their wielders. Battles are inevitably followed by famines. Just do what needs to be done, and then stop.
his purpose and does not glory in what he has done; Fulfils his purpose and does not boast of what he has done; Fulfils his purpose, but takes no pride in what he has done; Fulfils his purpose, but only as a step that could not be avoided. Fulfils his purpose, but without violence; For what has a time of vigour also has a time of decay. This is against Tao, And what is against Tao will soon perish.	not glory in them. Achieve results, but do not boast. Achieve results, but be not proud. Achieve results because there is no choice. Achieve results but do not overpower. Doing more than necessary brings exhaustion. This is not in harmony with Tao. What is not in harmony with Tao soon perishes.	Not daring (or) thinking to take by force Succeed but do not glorify Succeed but with no aggression Succeed but with no arrogance Succeed even not having gained the end Succeed but do not dominate A being grown mighty will then grow frail This may be called "off the path"	result, but does not praise his deeds. He achieves his result, and yet does not brag. He achieves his results, yet he abides with the result Because he has no choice. This is called "Achieving one's result without using violence". When things reach their prime, they get old; We call this "Not the way of Tao". What is not the way of Tao Will come to an early end.	Attain your purpose, but don't pres your advantage. Be resolute, but don't boast. Succeed, but don't crow. Accomplish, but don't overpower. Overdoing things invites decay, and this is against Tao. Whatever is against Tao soon ceases to be.

Fine weapons are none the less ill-omened things.

(People despise them, therefore,

Those in possession of the Tao do not depend on them.)

That is why, among people of good birth,

In peace the left-hand side is the place of honour,

But in war this is reversed and the right-hand side is the place of honour.

(Weapons are ill-omened things, which the superior man should not depend on.

When he has no choice but to use them,

The best attitude is to retain tranquil and peaceful.)

The Quietist, even when he conquers, does not regard weapons as lovely things.

For to think them lovely means to delight

Even the finest weapons are instruments of ill omen,

hated and feared by all creatures.

Observers of Tao have no use for them.

At home, a man of virtue gives precedence to the left.

At war, he gives precedence to the right.

Weapons are not the tools of a man of virtue.

Weapons are instruments of ill omen,

to be employed as a last resort.

Do not relish their use or admire their excellence.

To see weapons as

Even the finest weapons are tools of ill omen

Things somehow wrong to hold

So those who have the way do not linger

A noble one, when home, honors the left

When working with weapons, honors the right

Weapons are tools of ill omen

They are not a noble one's tools

Failing to gain satisfaction and still using them

Calm indifference is best adopted

Even in triumph there is no beauty

And those who are attracted to this

are in fact delighting in the slaughter of others

Now those who delight

Tools of violence

As for weapons - they are instruments of ill omen;

And among creatures there are those that hate them.

Therefore, who is a follower of Tao, never use them.

When the wise man is at home, he prefers the left.

When at war, he honors the right.

Therefore, they are not a wise man's tools.

Weapons are instruments of ill omen;

When you have no choice to use them,

It is best to remain tranquil and calm.

You should never look upon them

As things of beauty.

Weapons are tools of evil, shunned and avoided by everything in nature. Because people of Tao follow nature, they want nothing to do with weapons.

Unevolved people are eager to act out of strength, but a person of Tao values peace and quiet. He knows that every being is born of the womb of Tao. This means that his enemies are his enemies second, his own brothers and sisters first.

Thus he resorts to weapons only in the direst necessity, and then uses them

in them,

And to delight in them means to delight in the slaughter of men.

And he who delights in the slaughter of men

Will never get what he looks for out of those that dwell under heaven.

(Thus in happy events,

The left-hand side is the place of honour, in grief and mourning,

The right-hand is the place of honour.

The lieutenant general stands on the left,

While the supreme general stands on the right,

Which is arranged on the rites of mourning.)

A host that has slain men is received with grief and mourning;

excellent is to relish killing.

If you relish killing you will never find the way.

On joyful occasions, precedence is given to the left.

On sad occasions, precedence is given to the right.

When an army is arrayed, the lieutenant is placed on the left.

The commander is placed on the right.

Thus, war is conducted as a funeral rite.

When multitudes are being killed,

hold in your heart only sorrow.

When victory is achieved,

in the slaughter of others

Are then ill suited for use

in achieving any goal in the world at all

(In) auspicious affairs the left side is honored

(In) adverse affairs the right side is honored

An army's lieutenant commander stays to the left

The army's commander in chief stays to the right

A description of the funeral rites held at the end

Where the slaughter of others amounts to a multitude

Have compassion & lament & weep for them

(When) the battle is won

consider the funeral rites being held here

This is to delight the killing of men.

And when you delight in the killing of men;

You will not realize your goal in the land.

Therefore, on happy occasions we honor the left,

But in mourning we honor the right.

Therefore, in the army the general stands on the left,

And the commander-in-chief stands on the right.

Which is so to say, that war is conducted like a funeral.

When multitudes of people are killed,

We stand before them in sorrow and grief.

When we are victorious in battle,

We treat the occasion like a funeral ceremony.

with utmost restraint.

He takes no pleasure in victory, because to rejoice in victory is to delight in killing. Whoever delights in killing will not find success in this world.

Observe victories as you observe a death in the family: with sorrow and mourning.

Every victory is a funeral for kin.

When this simplicity is divided, every thing and not-thing needs a name. Once there are names, the process of distinction should stop. To know when to stop is to be free from danger.

Tao is eternal, but has no fame (name); The Uncarved Block, though seemingly of small account, Is greater than anything that is under heaven. If kings and barons would but possess themselves of it, The ten thousand creatures would flock to do them homage; Heaven-and-earth would conspire To send Sweet Dew, Without law or compulsion, men would	Tao is the uncarved block. Timeless, undefined, infinitesimally subtle. None is its master. If lords and princes observed it, the ten thousand things would arrive as guests to the table. Heaven and earth would rejoice and sweet nectar would fall, though none under	The way is continuous, without description The original nature may be ordinary But none in the world presumes to master it all If leaders & sovereigns were able to grasp this The myriad beings would then submit naturally (As) heaven and earth join together Thus to let fall the sweet dew Nobody has commanded this,	Shape The Tao is forever undefined. Though it seems small in its natural state, No one in the world dares to treat it as a subject. If kings and lords were able to maintain it, The ten thousand things would submit to them on their own. And Heaven Earth would unite to send forth sweet dew. By nature it would fall equally on all things,	The primal eternal Tao is an unnameable simplicity. Though small, there is nothing under all of heaven that can subjugate it. If a leader abides by it, all beings are naturally
dwell in harmony. Once the block is carved, there will be names, And so soon as there are names, Know that it is time to stop. Only by knowing when it is time to stop can danger be avoided. To Tao all under heaven will come As streams and torrents flow into a great river or sea.	heaven had decreed it. When the whole is divided the parts are named. There are already too many names. It is time to stop. Knowing when to stop avoids exhaustion. Tao in the world is like stream flowing to river flowing to sea.	yet the harmony is natural Begin with rules & definitions appear And still more definitions are already assumed Now, more than ever, prepare to learn restraint Learning restraint is apt to be useful in avoiding trouble Imagine the place of the path in nature To be like the streams and valleys reaching for rivers and ocean	among the people ordering that it be so. As soon as we start to establish a system, we have names. And as soon as there are set names, Then you must also know when it is time to stop. By knowing to stop - in this way you averts trouble. The presence of Tao in the world is like the relationship of small valley streams to rivers and seas.	drawn to him. Heaven and earth come together in harmony and sweet rain falls everywhere. People cooperate voluntarily, without any instruction. Tao in the world is like streams flowing into the sea.

To understand others is to have knowledge;

To understand oneself is to be illumined.

To conquer others needs strength;

To conquer oneself is harder still.

To be content with what one has is

One who knows others is wise.

One who knows self is enlightened.

One who masters others is strong.

One who masters self is powerful.

Knowing

To know others means intelligence

To know oneself means clarity

To overcome others is to have strength

To overcome oneself is to be powerful

To know satisfaction

Virtue

To understand others is to have wisdom;

To understand yourself is to be wise.

To conquer others is to have strength;

To conquer yourself is to be strong.

To know when you have enough

Knowing others is intelligence; knowing the self is enlightenment.

Conquering others is power; conquering the self is strength.

Know what is enough, and you'll be rich.

to be rich.

He that works through violence may get his way;

But only what stays in its place

Can endure.

When one dies one is not lost, there is no other longevity.

you have enough is fulfillment.

Exerting strong effort brings exhaustion.

He who abides where he is lasts long.

He who dies without ceasing is timelessly present.

means wealth

(To be) energetic in movement means to have purpose

To not forget one's own place means enduring

To die and yet not perish means longevity

is to be rich.

To go forward with strength is a sign of ambition.

To lose not your place is to last long.

To die but not to be forgotten -

That is true long life.

Persevere, and you'll develop a will.

Remain in the center, and you'll always be at home. Die without dying, and you'll endure forever.

Great Tao is like a boat that drifts; It can go this way; it can go that. The ten thousand creatures owe their existence to it and it does not disown them; Yet having produced them, it does not take possession of them. Makes no claim to be master over them, (And	Great Tao flows everywhere, left and right, all directions. The ten thousand things depend on it and it does not turn away. Its purpose is fulfilled but it lays no claim. It clothes and nourishes the ten thousand things but	How the great way (is a) flood! It is apt to go (both) left & right The myriad beings trust this for life, yet there are no explanations The work is completed, in spite of distinctions & claims The myriad beings are clothed & cared for yet	Tao favours no one The Tao flows and drifts everywhere, both to the left and to the right. It accomplishes its tasks and completes its affairs, And yet for this it is not given a name. The ten thousand things entrust their lives to it, And yet it does not act as their master. Thus it is constantly without desires. It can	The great Tao floods and flows in every direction. Everything in existence depends on it, and it doesn't deny them. It accomplishes its work without naming or making claims for itself.
asks for nothing from them.) Therefore it may be called the Lowly. The ten thousand creatures obey it, Though they know not that they have a master; Therefore it is called the Great. So too the Sage just because he never at any time makes a show of greatness In fact achieves greatness.	is not their lord. It desires nothing. It is smaller than small. The ten thousand things return to it but it is not their master. It is indeed great. Because it knows nothing of greatness, it is greater than great.	there is no assumption of leadership Ever dispassionate, (it) invites a reputation for commonness (But) the myriad beings return here, and still there is no acting as master Inviting a reputation for greatness Because it never regards itself as great So it is able to establish its greatness	be named with the things that are small. The ten thousand things entrust their lives to it, And yet it does not act as their master. It can be named with the things that are great. Therefore the Sage's ability to accomplish the great Comes from his not playing the role of the great. Therefore he is able to accomplish the great.	Everything in existence is clothed and nourished by it, but it doesn't lord over anything. Aimless, ambitionless, it might be called "small." Everything in existence returns to it, and still it doesn't lord over anything. Thus it might also be called "great." Because it has no desire to be great, it can achieve greatness.

He who holding the
Great From goes
about his work in the
empire

Can go about his, yet
do no harm.

All is peace,
quietness and
security.

Sound of music,
smell of good dishes

Will make the
passing stranger
pause.

How

Extol the great
illusion

and the men of the
world will gather.

Talk of success,
security and
happiness

and the multitudes
will flock.

Offer music and tasty
food and travelers

Grasp the big picture

(All) under heaven
make progress

Make progress while
doing no harm

Security and peace
abound

(For) music along
with fine food

The passing stranger
will linger

(But) the way, as
expressed in

Peace

Hold on to the Great
Image

And the whole world
will come to you.

Come to you and
suffer no harm;

But rather know
great safety and
peace.

Music and food -

For these passing
travelers stop.

Therefore, of the Tao
speaking, we

Stay centered in the
Tao and the world
comes to you:
Comes, and isn't
harmed; Comes, and
finds contentment.

Most travelers are
drawn to music and
good food.

When Tao is talked
about, the words can
seem bland and
flavourless.

difference the words
that Tao gives forth!

So thin, so
flavourless!

If one looks for Tao,
there is nothing solid
to see;

If one listens for it,
there is nothing loud
enough to hear.

Yet if one uses it, it is
inexhaustible.

will stop in.

Talk of Tao has no
flavor.

Look for it--there is
nothing to see.

Listen for it--there is
nothing to hear.

Merge with it--there
is no boundary or
end.

words

How insipid! It has
no flavor

Look at it, there is
nothing to satisfy the
sight

Listen for it, there is
nothing to satisfy the
hearing

(But) use it, is not
about to be used up

say:

Insipid, it is ! It is
lack of flavor.

When you look at it,
it is not sufficient to
be seen.

When you listen to it,
it is not sufficient to
be heard.

Yet when you use it,
it can't be used up.

Looked at, it may not
catch the eye.
Listened to, it might
not seduce the ear.
Used, it can never be
exhausted.

What is in the end to be shrunk Must first be stretched. Whatever is to be weakened Must begin by being made strong. What is to be overthrown Must begin by being set up. He who would be a taker Must begin as	If you want it to contract, let it expand. If you want it to weaken, let it gain strength. To bring a thing down, let it be raised high. To bring a thing	When desiring to contract a thing First be sure to expand it When desiring to weaken a thing First be sure to empower it When desiring to abolish a thing First be sure to promote it When desiring to despoil a thing	Influence If you wish to shrink it, You must certainly stretch it. If you wish to weaken it, You must certainly strenghten it. If you wish to desert it, You must certainly work close with it. If you wish to	What is ultimately to be reduced must first be expanded . What is ultimately to be weakened must first be made strong. What is ultimately to be discarded must first be embraced.
a giver. This is called "dimming" one's light. It is thus that the soft overcomes the hard And the weak, the strong. "It is best to leave the fish down in his pool; Best to leave the State's sharpest weapons wherenone can see them."	to you, let go. This is called "perceiving the subtle workings." Soft and weak overcome hard and strong. A fish should not leave deep water. A country should not show off its power.	First be sure to endow it This may be called "subtle discernment" The adaptable & gentle overcome the firm & strong Fish should not be removed from the depths The sharpest instruments of the state Should not be for showing to others	snatch something from it, You must certainly give something to it. This is called the Subtle Light. The submissive and weak conquer the strong. Fish should not be taken out of the depths; The state's sharp weapons should not be displayed.	What is ultimately to be taken away must first be given. This is called subtle insight. The soft overcomes the hard. The weak overcomes the strong. The Tao should never be abandoned. Weapons should never be displayed.

Tao never does; Yet through it all things are done. If the barons and kings would but possess themselves of it, The ten thousand creatures would at once be transformed. And if having been transformed they should	Tao does nothing yet nothing remains undone. When a noble man observes this the ten thousand things are transformed. When the desire to act re-emerges, it	The way always takes no action Yet nothing remains undone If leaders & sovereigns were able to grasp this The myriad beings would evolve by themselves Evolve and then want to flourish We can then	Quieting the heart Tao is constantly nameless, Were kings and lords able to maintain it, The ten thousand things would tranform on their own. Having transformed, were their desires to become active, I would subdue	Eternal Tao doesn't do anything, yet it leaves nothing undone. If you abide by it, everything in existence will transform itself.
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desire to act, We must restrain them by the blankness of the Unnamed. The blankness of the Unnamed Brings dispassion; To be dispassionate is to be still. And so, of itself, the whole empire will be at rest.	is stilled by the nameless no-thing. Without things there is no desire. Without desire there is stillness. In stillness, the realm of heaven and earth is perfect.	temper this with the original nature of namelessness (With) the original nature of namelessness Then these too would be without ambition Being free of ambition is the way to stillness Nature will then arrange itself	them with the nameless simplicity. Having subdued them with the nameless simplicity, I would not disgrace them. By not being disgraced, they will be tranquil. And Heaven and Earth will of themselves be correct and right.	When, in the process of self-transformation, desires are aroused, calm them with nameless simplicity. When desires are dissolved in the primal presence, peace and harmony naturally occur, and the world orders itself.
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As for the things that from of old have understood the Whole — The sky through such understanding remains limpid, Earth remains steady, The spirits keep their holiness, The abyss is replenished, The ten thousand creatures bear their kind, Barons and princes direct their people. It is the Whole that causes it. Were it not so limpid, the sky would soon get torn, Were is not for steadiness, the earth would soon tip over, Were it not for their holiness, the spirit would soon wither away. Were it not for this replenishment, the abyss would soon go dry,	Before time, these ancestors arise from One: Heaven arises from One and becomes clear. Earth arises from One and becomes firm. Spirit arises from One and becomes divine. Emptiness arises from One and becomes creation. The ten thousand things arise from One and become manifest. Kings and princes arise from One and become exalted. One is the source of All. Separated from the Source: the clearness of heaven would vanish,	These things, from the beginning, have grasped wholeness: Heaven attained the whole, becoming resolved Earth attained the whole, becoming steady Spirit attained the whole, becoming subtle The valley attained the whole, becoming replenished The myriad beings attained the whole, coming to life Leaders & sovereigns attained the whole as the way to attend to (all) under heaven These things found it Heaven, with no way to resolution, would threaten to split apart Earth, with no way to steadiness, would threaten to open up	Wholeness Of Those in ancient times That attained the one - Heaven by attaining the One became clear; Earth by attaining the One became stable; Gods by attaining the One became divine; Valleys by attaining the One became full; Kings and lords by attaining the One, Made the whole land ordered and secure. Talking this to its logical conclusion we would say - If Heaven were not by means of it clear, It would, I'm afraid, shatter. If the Earth were not by means of it stable, It would, I'm afraid, let go.	From ancient times these have attained oneness with Tao: Heaven attained oneness and became clear. Earth attained oneness and became peaceful. Spirits attained oneness and became strong. Valleys attained oneness and became full. Beings attained oneness and became fertile. All are what they are by virtue of oneness. Heaven without clarity would fall. Earth without peace would explode. Spirits without strength would —
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— — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — —	dissolve, the divinity of spirit would dissipate, creation would become desolation. The ten thousand things would perish, and kingdoms would disappear. Humility is the root of honor. Lowliness is the foundation of esteem. Thus, a noble man considers himself orphaned, bereft, unworthy. This is knowing the humble source—is it not? To seek praise is not praiseworthy. Do not jangle like jewelry.	— — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — —	— — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — —	dissipate. Valleys without fullness would dry up. Beings without fertility would die off. Sages without wholeness would stumble and fall. Humility is the root of greatness. Those in high positions do well to think of themselves as powerless, small and unworthy. Isn't this taking humility for the root? Attain honour without being honoured. Don't shine like jade, or chime like bells.
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In Tao the only
motion is returning;
The only useful
quality, weakness.
For though all

Tao moves by
returning and acts by
yielding.
Thus, the ten
thousand

Reversal is the
movement of the way
Yielding is the
method of the way

Application of Tao
Returning is the
motion of the Tao.
Weakness is the
function of the

Returning to the root
is the movement of
Tao.

creatures under
heaven are the
products of Being,
Being itself is the
product of Not-being.

things arise into
being.
Being arises from
non-being.
Things arise from
no-thing.

The myriad beings in
nature arose out of
being
Being arose out of
nothing

Tao.
The things of the
world
are born of being.
Being is born of not
being.

Quietness is how it
functions.
The ten thousand
things are born of
being. Being is born
of nothing.

When the man of highest capacities hears Tao He does his best to put it into practice. When the man of middling capacity hears Tao He is in two minds about it. When the man of low capacity hears Tao He laughs loudly at it. If he did not laugh, it would not be worth the name of Tao. Therefore the proverb has it: "The way out into the light often looks dark, The way that goes ahead often looks as if it went back." The way that is least hilly	When the wise student hears of Tao he practices diligently. When the average student hears of Tao he practices off and on. When the foolish student hears of Tao he laughs out loud. If the foolish do not laugh, it is not Tao. Thus it is said: The path of light is through darkness. The road ahead leads back. The easy way	Superior students, hearing of the way, Are diligent and practice it Average students, hearing of the way, Sometimes attend & sometimes forget Inferior students, hearing of the way, Laugh greatly about it Without the laughter there would be no grounds to regard this as the way And so the established proverbs hold that: Brightness, to the way, is as good as darkness Advance, to the way, is as good as retreat Evenness, to the way, is as	Travellers When the highest type of men hear of Way With diligence they are able to practice it; When average men hear of Tao Some things they retain and others they lose. When the lowest type of men hear of Way They laugh out loud at it. If they did not laugh at it, It could not be regarded as the Way. Therefore, there is a set saying about this that goes: The bright Way appears to be dark; The Way that goes forward appears to retreat; The smooth	When a wise person hears Tao, he practices it diligently. When an average person hears Tao, he practices it sometimes, and just as often ignores it. When an inferior person hears Tao, he roars with laughter. If he didn't laugh, it wouldn't be Tao. Thus the age old sayings: The way to illumination appears dark. The way that advances appears to retreat. The way that is easy appears to be hard.
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down, The "power" that is really loftiest looks like an abyss, What is sheerest white looks blurred. The "power" that is most sufficing looks inadequate, The "power" that stands firmest looks flimsy. What is in its natural, pure state looks faded; The largest square has no corners, The greatest vessel takes the longest to finish, Great music has the faintest notes, The Great From is without shape. For Tao is hidden and nameless.	is most difficult. The highest fulfillment is emptiness. True purity seems sullied. True abundance seems bereft. True power seems weak. True substance seems hollow. The greatest region has no boundaries. The best tools are fashioned slowly. The highest sounds are hard to hear. The perfect form has no shape. Tao is unseen, undefined. Yet Tao alone nourishes	good as roughness The summit of character is as good as a valley The greatest whiteness is as good as soiled Abundant character seems inadequate Established character seems furtive The evident truth seems spurious The greatest square has no corner The greatest capacity is last to be realized The greatest note is the rarest sound The greatest image has no form The way is hidden & nameless (But) because way is good at acceptance (it is) also fulfilling	Way appears to be uneven; The highest Virtue is empty like a valley; The purest white appears to be soiled; Vast Virtue appears to be insufficient; Firm Virtue appears to be thin and weak; The simplest reality appears to change. The Great Square has no corners; The Great Vessel takes long to complete; The Great Tone makes little sound; The Great Image has no shape. The Way is great but has no name. Only the Way is good at beginning things and also good to bring everything to fulfillment.	The highest virtue appears empty. The purest goodness appears soiled. The most profound creativity appears fallow. The strongest power appears weak. The most genuine appears unreal. The greatest space has no corners. The greatest talent matures slowly. The greatest voice can't be heard. The greatest image can't be seen. Tao is hidden and has no name. Tao alone nourishes and fulfills all things.
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Tao gave birth to the One; The One gave birth successively to two things, Three things, up to ten thousand. These ten thousand creatures cannot turn their backs to the shade Without having the sun on their bellies, And it is on this blending of the breaths that their harmony depends. To be orphaned, needy, ill-provided is what men	From Tao, One arises. From One, two. From two, three. Three becomes the ten thousand things. The ten thousand things carry yin on their backs and hold yang in their arms. Existence depends on the two. Men hate to be	The way begets the one The one begets the two The two beget the three The three beget the myriad beings The myriad beings carry the shadow and embrace the light Mixing the breaths with harmonious action People have their reasons to truly dislike being "Orphaned & friendless, without worth"	Harmony The Tao gave birth to the One. The One gave birth to the Two. The Two gave birth to Three. And the Three gave birth to the ten thousand things. The ten thousand things carry Yin on their backs and embrace Yang. Through the blending of Ch'i They achieve a state of harmony . The things that are hated in the whole world	Nonbeing gives birth to the oneness. The oneness gives birth to yin and yang. Yin and Yang give birth to heaven, earth, and beings. Heaven, earth, and beings give birth to everything in existence. Therefore everything in existence carries within it both yin and yang, and attains its harmony by blending together
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most hate; Yet princes and dukes style themselves so. Truly, "things are often increased by seeking to diminish them And diminished by seeking to increase them." The maxims that others use in their teaching I too will use in mine. Show me a man of violence that came to a good end, And I will take him for my teacher.	orphaned, bereft, unworthy, yet this is how the noble man describes himself. Loss is gain, gain is loss. I teach what has always been taught: "A fervent man is surprised by death." I see this as the foundation of my teaching.	duke take (these) as titles Since beings may sometimes lose something, and yet benefit May sometimes gain something, and yet be diminished What someone else has taught I too come to teach: Those who are forceful & hostile do not meet their (natural) ends I will regard (this) as a premise of the teaching	orphaned, widowed and worthless. Yet Kings and lords take these as their names. Thus with all things - some are increased by taking away; While some are diminished by adding on. Therefore, what other men teach, I will also consider and then teach to others. Thus, the strong and violent do not come to a natural end. I will take this as the father of my studies.	these two vital breaths. Ordinary people hate nothing more than to be powerless, small, and unworthy. Yet this is how superior people describe themselves. Gain is loss. Loss is gain. I repeat what others have said: The strong and violent don't die natural deaths. This is the very essence of my teaching.
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What is of all things most yielding Can overwhelm that which is of all things most hard. Being substanceless it can enter even where is no space; That	Under heaven, the soft and yielding overcomes the hard and strong. That without substance permeates the	Nature at its most yielding Quickly overcomes nature at its most firm Non-being enters (where) there is no gap This is how we know (that)	Overcoming the impossible The softest and most pliable thing in the world Runs roughshod over the firmest thing in the world. That which has no substance can enter Into that which has	The soft overcomes the hard in the world as a gentle rider controls a galloping horse. That without substance can penetrate where there is no space.
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is how I know the value of action that is actionless. But that there can be teaching without words, Value in action that is actionless, Few indeed can understand.	impenetrable. Thus, I embrace non-action. Teach without words. Work without doing. Few under heaven understand this.	inaction comes to have such advantages The doctrine which has no words The benefits of taking no action - Few in the world attain these	no spaces or cracks. I therefore know that there is benefit in taking no action. The wordless teaching, the benefit of taking no action - Few in the world can realize these!	By these I know the benefit of nonaction. Teaching without words, working without actions-nothing in the world can compare with them.
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Fame or one's own self, which matters to one most? One's own self or things bought, which should count most? In the getting or the losing, which is worse? Hence he who grudges expense pays dearest in the	Name or person, which is more dear? Person or possessions, which is more precious? Gain or loss, which is more harmful? Excessive desire incurs great expense. One	Reputation compared to life, which is dearer? Life compared to property, which is (worth) more? Gain compared to loss, which is (more) distressing? It is a given that extreme	Contentment Fame or your health: Which matters more? Your health or your wealth: Which is more precious? Gain or loss: In which is there harm? If your desires are great, you're bound to be extravagant; If you store	Which is more precious, fame or health? Which is more valuable, health or wealth? Which is more harmful, winning or losing? The more excessive your love, the greater your suffering.
end; He who has hoarded most will suffer the heaviest loss. Be content with what you have and are, and no one can despoil you; Who stops in time nothing can harm. He is forever safe and secure.	who hoards treasure suffers loss. One who knows enough is enough will always have enough. One who knows when to stop avoids exhaustion. Thus, he will endure.	affection Entails great cost Much stored up entails heavy loss To understand sufficiency is no disgrace To understand restraint avoids limits - (This is) the right way to live long	much away, you're bound to lose a great deal. Therefore, if you know contentment, you'll be not disgraced. If you know when to stop, you suffer no harm. And in this way you can last a very long time.	The longer you hoard, the heavier your losses. Knowing what is enough is freedom. Knowing when to stop is safety. Practice these, and you'll endure.

What is most perfect seems to have something missing; Yet its use is unimpaired. What is most full seems empty; Yet its use will never fail. What is most straight seems	Perfection appears imperfect but has no flaw. Fulfillment appears as emptiness but has no limit. Great truth is a paradox. Great	A great achievement (may) seem deficient But its function is not impaired A great fulfillment (may) seem empty But its function is not diminished Great straightforwardness (might)	Silence Great accomplishment seems incomplete, Yet its usefulness is never exhausted. Great fullness seems to be empty, Yet its usefulness is never used up. Great straightness seems to be twisted; Great skill seems	The greatest perfection seems imperfect, yet its usefulness is endless. The greatest fullness seems empty, yet its usefulness is inexhaustible. Great straightness seems flexible.
crooked; The greatest skill seems like clumsiness, The greatest eloquence like stuttering. Movement overcomes cold; But staying still overcomes heat. So he by his limpid calm Puts right everything under heaven.	wisdom is self-evident. Great eloquence is unpracticed. Movement overcomes cold. Stillness overcomes heat. Stillness and simplicity put all things right under heaven.	seem compromised Great artfulness (might) seem clumsy Great eloquence (might) seem to stammer Restlessness overcomes cold Stillness overcomes heat Clarity & stillness act as measures to the world	to be clumsy; Great eloquence seems to stammer; Great surplus seems to be lacking. Activity overcomes cold. Tranquility overcomes heat. If you are quiet and tranquil You can become the ruler of the world.	Great skill looks clumsy. Great eloquence sounds awkward. Movement triumphs over cold. Stillness triumphs over heat. Clarity and tranquility set the whole world in order.

When there is Tao in the empire

The galloping steeds are turned back to fertilize the ground by their droppings.

When there is not Tao in the empire

War horses will be reared even on the sacred mounds below the city walls.

(No lure is greater than to possess

When Tao is embraced in the realm,

race horses haul their own manure.

When Tao is unknown in the realm,

war horses are bred

When the world holds to the way

Retired racehorses are useful for manure

When the world loses the way

War horses breed throughout the frontier

There is no vice greater than

Desire

When the world has the Way,

Ambling horses are retired to fertilize fields.

When the world lacks the Way

War horses are bred outside the city.

Of sins - none is greater

than having things that

When the world practices Tao, horses fertilize the fields.

When the world ignores Tao, horses are bred for war.

There

what others want,)

No disaster greater than not to be content with what one has,

No presage of evil greater than men should be wanting to get more.

Truly:

"He who has once known the contentment that comes simply through being content,

Will never again be otherwise than contented".

at the borders.

There is no greater curse than desire, no greater misfortune than greed.

He who knows enough is enough

will always have enough.

submitting to greed

No suffering greater than never knowing sufficiency

No error greater than the hunger for gain

So to know that sufficiency is in itself sufficient

Is a truly durable sufficiency

one desire,

Of disasters - none is greater

than not knowing when one has enough.

Of defects - none brings greater sorrow than desire to attain.

Therefore he who knows that enough is enough is abiding contentment indeed.

is no greater calamity than desire, no greater curse than greed.

Know that enough is enough, and you'll always have enough.

Without leaving his door
He knows everything under heaven.
Without looking out of his window
He knows all the ways of heaven.
For

Without leaving home one can know the whole world.
Without looking outside one can see heaven.
Looking afar

Without going out the door
Comprehend (all) under heaven
Without peering out the window
Observe the way of heaven
The farther beyond one goes
One's comprehension is

Experience
No need to leave your door,
To know the whole world.
No need to peer through your windows,
To know the Way of

Without going out the door, you can know the world.
Without looking out the window, you can see heaven.

the further one travels
The less one knows.
Therefore the Sage arrives without going,
Sees all without looking,
Does nothing, yet achieves everything.

does not find what is near.
Thus, the sage knows without learning,
sees without seeking,
acts without doing.

by that much diminished
This is why wise ones (might) not move about, but still know
(Might) not witness, but still describe
(Might) not act, but still accomplish

Heaven.
The further you go, the less you know.
Therefore the Sage knows without going;
Names without seeing;
And completes without doing a thing.

The farther you travel, the less you know.
Thus the wise person knows without traveling,
understands without seeing, accomplishes without acting.

Learning consists in adding to one's stock day by day;
The practice of Tao consists in "subtracting day by day,
Subtracting and yet again subtracting
Till one has reached inactivity.
But by this

For students of knowledge,
every day something is acquired.
For observers of Tao,
every day something falls away.
Less and less is done until not-doing is achieved.
When there

The pursuit of learning (means) increasing daily
The pursuit of the way (means) decreasing daily
Decreasing things and then subtracting
In order to arrive at not doing
(When) nothing is done, then

Knowledge
Those who work at their studies
Increase day after day;
Those who have heard the Tao
Decrease day after day.
They decrease and decrease,
till they get to the point where they do nothing.
They do nothing and yet there

In the pursuit of learning, every day something is added.
In the pursuit of Tao, every day something is dropped.
Less and less is done, until one arrives at nonaction.

very inactivity
Everything can be activated."
Those who of old won the adherence of all who live under heaven
All did so not interfering.
Had they interfered,
They would never have won this adherence.

is no doer,
nothing remains to be done.
The realm of heaven and earth
is ruled by timeless principles.
He who tries to interfere is not ready to receive it.

nothing remains undone
To capture the world, always apply the least effort
As soon as one has to make effort
(One is) no longer adequate to the purpose
of capturing the world

is nothing left undone.
When someone wants to take control of the world,
He must always be unconcerned with affairs.
For in a case where he is concerned with affairs,
He will be unworthy as well,
of taking control of the world

When nothing is done, nothing is left undone. The world is won by letting things take their own course.
If you still have ambitions, its out of your reach.

The Sage has no heart of his own; He uses the heart of the people as his heart. Of the good man I approve, But of the bad I also approve, And thus he gets goodness. The truthful man I believe, but the liar I also believe, And thus he	The sage has no heart or mind of his own. Thus, he knows the heart and mind of all. I am good to the good and good to the not-so-good. This is the goodness of Virtue. I trust the trustworthy and have faith	Wise ones have no set mind Regarding the hundred families' minds as "mind" To those who are good we have good to extend To those who are less than good we also have good to extend To merit goodness To those who are true we have truth to extend To those	The world of others The Sage constantly has no mind of his own. He takes the mind of the common people as his mind. Those who are good, he regards as good. Those who are not good, he regards also as good. In this way he attains goodness. Those who are trustworthy, he trusts. Those	The sage has no set mind. She adopts the concerns of others as her own. She is good to the good. She is also good to the bad. This is real goodness. She trusts the trustworthy.
gets truthfulness. The Sage, in the dealings with the world, seems like one dazed with fright; For the world's sake he dulls his wits. The Hundred Families all the time strain their eyes and ears, The Sage all the time sees and hears no more than an infant sees and hears.	in those who should not be trusted. This is the faith of Virtue. The sage is in harmony with the realm of heaven and earth. His mind is merged with the world. People turn to him and listen. He treats them as his children.	who are less than true we also have truth to extend To merit truth Wise ones are in the world Uniting, connecting, adopting the world Merging with their hearts The hundred families, as one, pay heed, with their "hearkening" & "beholding" The wise ones, as one, come to laugh like children	who are not trustworthy, he also trusts. [In this way] he gets their trust. As for the Sage's presence in the world - he is one with it. And with the World he merges his mind. The common people all fix their eyes and ears on him. And the Sage treats them all as his children.	She also trusts the untrustworthy. This is real trust. The sage takes the minds of the worldly and spins them around. People drop their ideas and agendas, and she guides them like beloved children.

He who aims at life achieves death. If the "companions of life" are thirteen, So likewise are the "companions of death" thirteen. How is it that the "death-stops" in man's life And activity are also thirteen? It is because men feed life too grossly. It is said that he who has a true hold on life, When he walks on land does	In the passage from womb to grave one in three are disciples of living. One in three are disciples of death. One in three are just passing through. All believe they have life. He who knows the truth of existence does not	Emerging in life (or) entering death The companions of life will be three (in) ten The companions of death will be three (in) ten And others whose lives & actions approach the domain of death Will also be three (in) ten Now why is this so? Because these live life for its substance Now hear of the one adept at	Life and death We come out into life and go back in death. The companions of life are thirteen; The companions of death are thirteen; And yet people, because they regard life as LIFE, In all of their actions move forward to the thirteen that belong to the realm of death. Now, why is this so? Because they regard as LIFE. You have no doubt heard of those	Between their births and their deaths, three out of ten are attached to life, three out of ten are attached to death, three out of ten are just idly passing through. Only one knows how to die and stay dead and still go on living. That one hasn't any ambitions, hasn't any ideas, makes no plans. From this mysterious place of not-knowing and non-doing he gives birth to whatever is needed in the moment.
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not meet tigers or wild buffaloes; In battle he is not touched by weapons of war. Indeed, A buffalo that attacked him would find nothing for its horns to butt, A tiger would find nothing for its claws to tear, A weapon would find no place for its point to enter in. And why? Because such men have no "death-spot" in them.	fear wild bulls or tigers. He wears no armor in battle. Bulls have no place to thrust their horns. Tigers have no place to sink their claws. Weapons have no place to enter. Why is this? Because death is for the living.	sustaining life Traveling the countryside, not meeting buffalo or tiger Entering a battle, not carrying armor or weapons - The buffalo finds no place to thrust its horns The tiger finds no place to sink its claws The weapon finds no place to admit its blade Now why is this so? Because in this one there is no place for death	at holding on to life: When they walk through hills, They do not avoid rhinoceros or tiger. When they go to battle, They do not put on armor or shields: The rhinoceros has no place to probe with its horn; The tiger has no place to put its claws; And weapons find no place to hold their blades. Now, why is this so? Because there is no place for death in them.	Because he is constantly filling his being with nonbeing, he can travel the wilds without worrying about tigers or wild buffalo, or he can cross a battlefield without armour or weapon. No tiger can claw him. No buffalo can gore him. No weapon can pierce him. Why is this so? Because he has died, there isn't any more room for death in him.
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Tao gave them birth; The "power" of Tao reared them, Shaped them according to their kinds, Perfected them, giving to each its strength. Therefore Of the ten thousand things there is not one that does not worship Tao And do homage to its "power". No mandate ever went forth that accorded to Tao the right to be worshipped,	Tao gives them life. Virtue gives them nourishment. The manifest world gives them form. The tendencies of each make them what they are. Therefore the ten thousand things honor Tao and esteem Virtue. This honor and esteem are not commanded. It is	The way gives things life Character raises them Existence shapes them Conditions complete them So it is that the myriad beings, without exception, Ennoble the way and honor character The way will be ennobled Character will be honored But nobody has to command this as it always proceeds	Love Tao gives birth to them and Virtue nourishes them. Substance gives them form And their unique capacities complete them. Therefore the ten thousand things As for their veneration of Tao and their honouring of Virtue - No one rewards them for it; it is constantly so on its own. Tao gives birth to	Tao gives life to all beings. Nature nourishes them. Fellow creatures shape them. Circumstances complete them. Everything in existence respects Tao and honours nature - not by decree, but spontaneously. Tao gives life to all beings.
to its "power" the right to receive homage. It was always and of itself so. Therefore as Tao bore them and the "power" of Tao reared them, Made them grow, fostered them, Harboured them, Brewed for them, So you must rear them, but not lay claim to them, Control them, but never lean upon them, Be chief among them, but not manage them. This is called the mysterious power."	just the nature of things. And so, all things arise from Tao. By Virtue they are nourished, developed, clothed, sheltered, soothed, aged and buried. To create without possessing, to act without making claims, to lead without taking command— this is timeless Virtue.	out of nature In this way the way gives things life Character raises them Sustains them, brings them up Shelters them, heals them Nurtures them, protects them Creates but does not possess Acts but does not expect Leads but does not rule These may be called "mystic powers"	them, nourishes them and matures them, Completes them, rests them, Rears them, supports them, And protect them. It gives birth to them But does not try to own them; It acts on their behalf But does not make them dependent; It matures them But does not rule them. This is what we call Profound Virtue.	Nature watches over them, develops them, shelters them, nurses them, grows them, ripens them, completes them, buries them, and returns them. Giving birth, nourishing life, shaping things without possessing them, serving without expectation of reward, leading without dominating: These are the profound virtues of nature, and of nature's best beings.

That which was the
beginning of all
things under heaven

We may speak of as
the "mother" of all
things.

He who apprehends
the mother

Thereby knows the
sons.

And he who has
known the sons,

Will hold all the
tighter to the mother,

And to the end of his
days suffer no harm;

"Block the passages,
shut the doors,

And till the end

Where the realm of
heaven and earth
begins

could be called the
mother of creation.

Knowing the mother,
become the child.

Being the child, stay
close to the mother.

Death will not bother
you.

Stay quiet, keep
inside,

and you will

The world had a
beginning

Regarded as mother
to the world

Having found this
mother

Through this
comprehend her
children

Having
comprehended her
children

Return & attend to
the mother

The death of self is
nothing to fear

Close the passages

Secure the gates

(And) the rest of life
is no trouble

Restraint

The World had a
beginning,

Which can be
considered as the
mother of the World.

Having attained the
mother,

In order to
understand her
children,

If you return and
hold on to the
mother,

Until the end of your
life you will suffer no
harm

Block up the holes;

Close the doors,;

The origin and
mother of everything
in the world is Tao.

Know the mother and
you can know the
children. Having
known the children,
return to their source
and hold on to her.
Abiding by the
mother, you are free
from danger, even
when your body dies.

Don't live for your
senses. Close your
mouth, close all the
body's openings, and
reside in the original
unity.

your strength shall
not fail.

Open up the
passages, increase
your doings,

And till your last day
no help shall come to
you."

As good sight means
seeing what is very
small

So strength means
holding on to what is
weak.

He who having used
the outer-light can
return to the
innerlight

Is thereby preserved
from all harm.

never want for
anything.

Open your mouth,
meddle in affairs,
and you are beyond
rescue.

Perceiving the subtle
is insight.

To yield requires
strength.

Use the light of
creation to become
illuminated

and thus be saved.

This is called
"entering the
Absolute."

Open the passages

Conclude the affairs
(And) the rest of life
finds no salvation

To perceive in detail
tells of clarity

To maintain
flexibility tells of
strength

Make use of what is
illuminated

To return home again
to the light

Do not abandon
yourself to
misfortune

This may be called
"sustainable practice"

will not labor.

Open the holes;

Meddle in affairs;

And till the end of
your life

you will not be
saved.

To perceive the small
is called
"discernment".;

To hold on to the
pliant is called
"strength".

If you use the rays, to
return to the bright
light,

You will not abandon
your life to peril.

In this way you can
pass your life in
peace and
contentment.

Open your mouth,
increase your
activities, start
making distinctions
between things, and
you'll toil forever
without hope.

See the subtle and be
illuminated. Abide in
gentleness and be
strong.

Use your light, and
return to insight.
Don't expose
yourself to trouble.
This is following
Tao.

He who has the least
scrap of sense,
Once he has got
started on the great
highway has nothing
to fear
So long as he avoids
turnings.
For great highways
are safe and easy.
But men love
by-paths.
So long as Court is in
order
They

If I have the least bit
of knowledge
I will follow the great
Way alone
and fear nothing but
being sidetracked.
The great Way is
simple
but people delight in
complexity.
The government is
corrupt.

Let our resolve here
be this: to be
understanding
To travel upon the
great way
(With) only
distractions to fear
The great way is so
very ordinary
And the people love
the detours
The courts are so
very well kept
The fields,

Distractions
Were I have the least
bit of knowledge,
In walking on a Great
Road
it is only going stray
that I Would fear.
Keeping to the main
road is easy,
But people greatly
delight in tortuous
paths.
The courts are swept
very clean;
While the fields are
full

Because I have a
little wisdom, I
choose to walk the
great path of Tao and
fear nothing except
to stray from it.
The great way is very
smooth and easy, but
some people are fond
of getting
sidetracked.
When a ruler's palace
is full of treasure, the
people's fields are
weedy and

are content to let
their fields run to
weed
And their granaries
stand empty.
They wear patterns
and embroideries,
Carry sharp swords,
glut themselves with
drink and food,
Have more
possessions than they
can use.
These are the riotous
ways of brigandage;
they are not the
Highway.

The fields are
overgrown.
The granaries are
empty.
Yet some wear fine
clothes,
carry sharp swords,
gorge on food and
drink,
and are surrounded
by luxury.
They are thieves.
This is certainly not
the great Way.

so very weedy
The granaries, so
very empty
The clothes, refined
& elaborate
Sharp swords worn at
the waist
A glut of drinking &
feasting
Wealth & goods kept
in heaps
This describes
robbery & bombast
Surely not the way at
all

of weeds;
And the granaries are
all empty.
Their clothing -
richly embroidered
and colored,
While at their waists
they carry sharp
swords,
And indulge
themselves with food
and drink;
And of possessions
they have plenty.
It is called thievery!
And thievery is
certainly not the way
of Tao.

their granaries are
empty.
If the ruler wears
fancy clothes and his
house is full of
weapons, if his table
is laden with
extravagant food and
drink and everywhere
one looks he has
more wealth than he
can use, the ruler is a
robber and thief. This
is not in keeping with
Tao.

What Tao plants cannot be plucked, What Tao clasps, cannot slip. By its virtue alone can one generation after another carry on the ancestral sacrifice. Apply it to yourself and by its power you will be freed from dross. Apply it to your household and your household shall thereby have abundance. Apply it to the village, and the village will be made secure. Apply it to the kingdom, and the kingdom shall	What is deeply rooted will not topple. What is firmly grasped will not slip away. It will be honored through generations of ancestors. Cultivated in the self, Virtue is manifest. Cultivated in the family, Virtue grows. Cultivated in the village, Virtue flourishes. Cultivated in the nation,	What is well established is not uprooted What is well embraced is not taken away Children & grandchildren, accordingly, make offerings & sacrifice without fail Cultivate this in the person Its character grows true Cultivate this in the family Its character grows ample Cultivate this in the community Its character grows enduring	Go by love What is firmly set up cannot be pulled down. What is firmly embraced cannot slip away. And our sons and grandsons, as a result, Will sacrifice without end. When you cultivate it in your self, Your virtue will then be genuine; When you cultivate it in your family, Your virtue will then overflow; When you cultivate it in your village, Your virtue will then be long lasting;	Plant yourself firmly in the Tao and you won't ever be uprooted. Embrace Tao firmly and you won't ever be separated from it. Your children will thrive, and your children's children. Cultivate goodness in your self, and goodness will be genuine. Cultivate it in your family, and goodness will flourish.
thereby be made to flourish. Apply it to an empire, and the empire shall thereby be extended. Therefore just as through oneself one may contemplate Oneself, So through the household one may contemplate the Household, And through the village, one may contemplate the Village, And through the kingdom, one may contemplate the Kingdom, And through the empire, one may contemplate the Empire. How do I know that the empire is so?	Virtue abounds. Cultivated in the universe, Virtue is everything. As the self, observe the self. As the family, observe the family. As the village, observe the village. As the nation, observe the nation. As the universe, observe the universe. How do I know the universe? Like this.	Its character grows bountiful Cultivate this in the world Its character grows universal And so, use person to examine the person With family, examine the family With community, examine the community With country, examine the country With the world, examine the world So how are we to know that the world is really like this? Through This	you cultivate it in your nation, Your virtue will then be abundant; When you cultivate it throughout the world, Your virtue will then be widespread. Use the individual to examine the individual; Use the family to examine the family; Use the village to examine the village; Use the nation to examine the nation; And use the world to examine the world. How do I know that the world is so? By this!	Cultivate it in your community, and goodness will grow and multiply. Cultivate it in your country, and goodness will be abundant. Cultivate it in the world, and goodness will be everywhere. How do I know the world works like this? By watching.

The impunity of things fraught with the "power" May be likened to that of an infant. Poisonous insects do not sting it, Nor fierce beasts seize it, Nor clawing birds maul it, Its bones are soft, its sinews weak; but its grip is strong. Not yet to have known the union of male and female, But to be completely formed, Means that the vital force is at its height; To be able to scream all	A man of Virtue can be compared to a newborn child. Snakes and scorpions do not strike him. Fierce beasts do not prey upon him. Birds of prey do not attack him. Though his bones are soft and his muscles weak, his grip is firm. Without knowing the union of man and woman, his organ stands erect. His vital force is strong. He	To embody virtue's substance Compares to the naked infant Wasps & scorpions, vipers & serpents do not bite Wild beasts do not seize Birds of prey do not strike The bones are flexible, the muscles are soft, but the grip is sure Not yet knowing the union of woman & man But the penis is aroused Essence is at its prime here! Howling all day,	Love and Nature One who embraces the fullness of Virtue Can be compared with a newborn child. Wasps and scorpions, snakes and vipers Will not sting him; Birds of prey and fierce beasts Do not seize him; His bones are soft, his muscles weak and pliant, Yet his grip is firm. He has not experienced the union of Man and woman, yet his organ is aroused. This is because his essence is at his height. He can scream all	She who is filled with goodness is like a newborn child: wasps and snakes will not bite it, fierce beasts will not attack it, birds of prey will not pounce on it. Its bones are soft and its muscles weak, but its grip is firm. It hasn't yet known the union of male and female, yet its organ stirs with vitality.
day without getting hoarse Means that the harmony is at its perfection. To understand such harmony is to understand the always so. To understand the always-so is to be illuminated. But to fill life to the brim is to invite omens. If the heart makes calls upon the life-breath, rigidity follows. Whatever has a time of vigour also has a time of decay. Such things are against Tao,	can scream all day without becoming hoarse. His harmony is perfect. To know harmony is to know the everlasting. To know the everlasting is enlightenment. To interfere with life is ill-fated. To control the breath causes strain. If you exert yourself you will become exhausted. This is not in harmony with Tao.	but not getting hoarse Harmony is at its prime here! To comprehend harmony speaks of the continuous To comprehend the continuous speaks of clarity The enrichment of life may be called a "happy omen" The mind directing the breath may be called a "power" (But) beings grown mighty will then grow frail This may be called "off the path" Off the path is soon finished	day, Yet without becoming hoarse. This is because his harmony is at its height. To know harmony is called "the constant." To know the constant is called "being wise." To add on to life is called "a bad omen." For the mind to control the breath - That is called "forcing things." When things has reached their prime they get old. This is called "not the way of Tao." What is not the Way Will come to an early end.	It can howl all day without becoming hoarse, so perfect is its harmony. To know harmony is to know the eternal. To know the eternal is to be illumined. Prolonging life is not harmonious./ Coercing the breath is unnatural. Things which are overdeveloped must decay. All this is contrary to Tao, and whatever is contrary to Tao soon ceases to be.

Those who know do not speak; Those who speak do not know. Black the passages, Shut the doors, Let all sharpness be blunted, All tangles untied, All glare tempered. All dust smoothed. This is called the mysterious	One who knows does not talk about it. One who talks about it does not know. Stay quiet. Keep inside. Blunt sharpness. Unravel entanglements. Diffuse brightness. Merge with dust. This	To know does not mean to speak To speak does not mean to know Close the passages Secure the gates Blunt the sharpness Resolve the tangles Shade the glare Be one with the world This may be called "mystic union" Such as may	Impartiality Those who know do not talk about it. Those who talk do not know about it. He blocks up his holes, Closes his doors, Softens the glare, Settles the dust, Files down the sharp edges, And unties the tangles. This is called the profound union. Therefore, there is	Those who know don't talk. Those who talk don't know. Close your mouth. Block the door. Quiet your senses. Blunt the sharpness. Untie the tangles. Soften the brightness.
leveling. He who has achieved it cannot either be drawn into friendship or repelled, Cannot be benefited, cannot be harmed, Cannot either be raised or humbled, And for that very reason is highest of all creatures under heaven.	is called "discovering original nature." One who knows original nature is indifferent to intimacy and estrangement, unconcerned with benefit and harm, immune to honor and disgrace. He is embraced by heaven.	not be gained by affection May not be gained by detachment May not be gained by favor May not be gained by suffering May not be gained by esteem May not be gained by humility And so becomes precious to (all) under heaven	no way To get intimate with him. There is no way to benefit him, But there is also no way to harm him. There is no way to ennoble him. But there is also no way to debase him For this reason he is the noblest thing in the world.	Be one with the dust, and enter the primal oneness. One who has merged with Tao in this way can't be courted, can't be bought, can't be harmed, can't be honoured, can't be humiliated. He is the treasure of the world.

"Kingdoms can only be governed if rules are kept;

Battles can only be won if rules are broken."

But the adherence of all under heaven can only be won by letting-alone.

How do I know that it is so?

By this.

The more prohibitions there are, the more ritual avoidances,

The poorer the people will be.

The more "sharp weapons" there are,

The more benighted will the whole land grow.

The more cunning craftsmen there are,

Rule the country with sincerity.

Wage war with cunning.

Master the universe with indifference.

How do I know this is the way it is?

Because of this:

The more taboos, the poorer the people's spirit.

The sharper men's weapons, the more trouble in the land.

The greater the ingenuity, the more clutter in

Use principle to govern a country

Use tricks to wage a war

Use the least effort to capture the world

By what means do we know that things are really like this?

By This

There are more taboos & restrictions in the world

But the people grow more impoverished

The people have more productive implements

(But) countries & clans grow more disturbed

(As) others get

Government

Use the upright and correct to order the state;

Use surprise tactics when you use troops.

Use unconcern with affairs

To take control of the world.

How do I know that this is so?

Well, the more taboos and prohibitions

There are in the world,

The poorer the people will be;

The more sharp weapons the people possess,

The more muddled the states will be.

The more knowledge and skill people have,

The

Govern a nation by following nature.

Fight a war with unexpected moves.

Win the world by letting go. How do I know this? From seeing these:

The more prohibitions there are, the poorer people become. The more weapons there are, the darker things become.

The more laws

be invented.

The more laws are promulgated,

The more thieves and bandits there will be.

Therefore a sage has said:

So long as I "do nothing" the people will of themselves be transformed.

So long as I love quietude, the people will of themselves go straight.

So long as I act only by inactivity the people will of themselves become prosperous.

So long as I have no wants

the world.

The more abundant the laws, the more abundant the thieves.

Therefore the sage says:

I take no action and the people naturally reform.

I remain at peace and the people become content.

I do not meddle and the people become prosperous.

I desire nothing and the people return to original nature.

more clever & artful

Bizarre things happen more often

The more that matters of law are proclaimed

The more robbers & looters there will be

And so the wise ones will claim:

We do nothing

And humanity evolves on its own

We favor stillness

And humanity governs itself

We do not make an effort

And humanity enriches itself

We have no ambition

more novel things will appear.

The more legal matters are made prominent,

The more robbers and thieves there will be.

Therefore the words of the Sage say:

I do nothing,

And the people of themselves are transformed.

I love tranquility,

And people of themselves are upright.

I am unconcerned with affairs,

And the people of themselves become rich.

I desire not to desire,

and the people of themselves

Are genuine and simple, like unvarved wood.

there are, the greater the number of scoundrels.

Therefore the sage says: I take no action, and people transform themselves. I love tranquility, and people naturally do what is right.

I don't interfere, and people prosper on their own. I have no desires, and people return to simplicity.

When the ruler looks repressed the people will be happy and satisfied; When the rule looks lively and self-assured the people will be carping and discontented. "It is upon bad fortune that good fortune leans, upon good fortune that bad fortune rests." But though few know it, there is a	When government does not interfere, the people are genuine. When government intrudes, the people are cunning. Happiness is founded on misery. Misery lurks within happiness. Is there an end to it? Nothing stays	(Where) their government is muted & dull Its people are honest & sincere (Where) their government is efficient & exacting Its people are partial & wanting Ah, suffering! That happiness has such things to rely on! Ah, happiness! That suffering has such places to lurk! Who comprehends their outcomes? Are there	Be forgiving When the government is muddled and confused, The people are genuine and sincere. When the government is discriminate and clear, The state is crafty and cunning. Disaster is that on which good fortune depends. Good fortune is that in which disaster is concealed. Who knows where it will end?	When the government is dull and sleepy, people are wholesome and good. When the government is sharp and exacting, people are cunning and mean. Good rests upon bad. Bad hides within good. Who knows where the turning point is?
bound where there is neither right nor wrong; In a realm where every straight is doubled by a crooked, And every good by an ill, surely mankind has gone long enough astray? Therefore the Sage Squares without cutting, Shapes the corners without iopping, Straightens without stretching, Gives forth light without shining.	the same. Honesty moves with deceit. Good flows with evil. But people's delusion persists. Thus, the sage is sharp but not divisive, straightforward but not hurtful, principled but not severe, illuminated but not blinding.	no rules? The rules go back to behaving strangely The good return to acting ominously Humankind has held its delusions For such an entrenched length of days This is why wise ones Are direct but not divisive Exacting but not hurtful To the point but not tactless Bright but not dazzling	For there is no [fixed] "correct". The correct turns into the "deviant". And good turns into evil. People's state of confusion Has certainly existed for a long time. Therefore be square but do not cut, Be sharp but do not stab, Be straightforward but not unrestrained, Be bright but do not dazzle.	Whether government or person, if you aren't tranquil and honest, the normal flips to the abnormal, the auspicious reverts to the bizarre, and your bewilderment lasts for a long time. Therefore the sage does what is right without acting righteous, points without piercing, straightens without straining, enlightens without dazzling.

You cannot rule men
nor serve heaven
unless you have laid
up a store;
This "laying up a
store" means quickly
absorbing,
And "quickly
absorbing" means
doubling one's
garnered "power".
Double your
garnered power and
it acquires a strength
that nothing can
overcome.
If there is nothing it
cannot overcome, it
know no bounds,

In leading people and
serving heaven,
nothing surpasses
humility.
Humility is having
no preferences.
Humility
accumulates virtue.
Where virtue
accumulates, nothing
is impossible.
When nothing is
impossible, there are

(In) governing people
(or) serving heaven
There is nothing
quite like economy
Only one who is
thrifty
May be deemed
ahead of the task
To be ahead of the
task suggests there is
a great reserve of
character
Given a great reserve
of character
then nothing is
impossible
When

Restraint
For ordering
humanity and serving
Heaven,
Nothing is so good as
being sparing.
For only if you are
sparing can you,
Therefore, early
submit to The Way.
Early submission -
This is called
To repeatedly
accumulate Virtue
If you repeatedly
accumulate Virtue,
Then there is nothing
you cannot
overcome.
When there

In governing people
and serving heaven,
there is nothing
better than
moderation.
To be moderate is to
follow Tao without
straying. To follow
Tao without straying
is to become filled
with good energy. To
be filled with good
energy is to
overcome all things.

And only what
knows no bounds is
huge enough to keep
a whole kingdom in
its grasp.
But only he who
having the kingdom
goes to the Mother
can keep it long.
This is called the art
of making the roots
strike deep by
fencing the trunk,
Of making life long
by fixed staring.

no limits.
A man without limits
is fit to rule the
realm.
The mother of the
realm is everlasting.
This is called being
deeply rooted.
Timeless awareness
of Tao.

nothing is impossible
then nobody knows
things to be limited
Nobody knowing
things to be limited
is fit to claim the
realm
(Now) claiming the
realm's mother
is fitness to endure a
long time
This describes deep
roots & solid
foundations
The path of long life
& enduring vision

is nothing you cannot
overcome,
No one knows where
it will end,
You can possess the
state.
And when you
possess the mother of
the state,
You can last a very
long time.
This is called having
deep roots
and a firm base.
It is the Way of long
life and long-lasting
vision.

To overcome all
things is to know that
all things are
possible.
She who knows that
all things are possible
is fit to govern
people.
Because she is one
with the mother, her
roots go deep, her
foundation stands
firm, her life lasts
long, her vision
endures.

Ruling a large kingdom is indeed like cooking small fish.

They who by Tao all that is under heaven

Did not let an evil spirit within them display its powers.

Nay, it was not only that the evil spirit did not display its powers;

Neither was the

Governing a country is like cooking a delicate fish.

Rule in observance of Tao

and the forces of adversity become harmless.

They do

Ruling a great country is like cooking a little fish

This is how the way manages (all) under heaven

(Whether) the ghosts lack spirit

Or the ghosts do not lack spirit

(Whether) the spirits

Emotions

Ruling a large state is like cooking a small fish.

When you use the Way to govern the world,

Evil spirits will not have godlike power,

It is that their power will not harm men.

Governing a large country is like cooking a small fish.

If it's done in accordance with Tao, nothing bad will happen. Guide the world with Tao, and evil won't be a problem.

Not that it won't

Sage's good spirit used to the hurt of other men.

Nor was it only that his good spirit was not used to harm other men,

The Sage himself was thus saved from harm.

And so, each being saved from harm,

Their "powers" could converge towards a common end.

not lose their power, only their power to harm.

The sage, too, does no harm

and so he is not harmed.

Virtue flows unimpeded.

avoid harming people

Or the spirits do not avoid harming people

Wise ones still avoid harming people

Now as neither of these haunts the other

So virtue interacts & comes back home to them

But it is not only that their powers will not harm men,

The sage also, will not harm them.

Since these two do not do not harm others,

Therefore their Virtues intermingle and returns to them.

be around, but it won't find an opening, it can't harm anyone.

The sage doesn't harm anyone, either. When there's no harm on this side, no harm on that, goodness flows back and forth like water.

A large kingdom must be like the low ground towards which all streams flows down.

It must be a point towards which all things under heaven converge.

Its part must be that of the female in its dealings with all things under heaven.

The female by quiescence conquers the male; by quiescence gets underneath.

If a large kingdom can in the same way succeed in getting underneath a small kingdom

Then it will win the adherence of the small kingdom;

And

A country becomes great by lying low, like the delta of a great river.

The confluence of the realm.

The mother of the world.

The female conquers the male by stillness.

Being still, she takes the lower position.

A great country conquers a small country by taking the lower

The great realm is the one which flows beneath

A confluence to (all) under heaven

A woman to (all) under heaven

The feminine, ever through stillness, overcomes the male

Through stillness & playing submissive

And so a great realm, by submitting to a small realm,

Will then appropriate the small realm

A small realm, by submitting to a great realm,

Will then

International relations

A large state is like the lower part of a river.

It is the female of the world.

It is the meeting point of the world.

The female constantly overcomes

The male with tranquility.

Because she is tranquil,

Therefore she is fittingly underneath.

The large state - if it is below the small state,

Then it takes over the small state.

The small state -

A great country is like a low-lying land into which many streams flow. It draws powerful energies to it as a receptive woman draws an eager man. The feminine can always conquer the masculine by yielding and taking the lower position. In this way she becomes as low-lying land: in time, everything comes her way.

Therefore a great country can win over a small country by practicing humility.

it is because small kingdoms are by nature in this way underneath large kingdoms

That they win the adherence of large kingdoms.

The one must get underneath in order to do it;

The other is underneath and therefore does it.

(What large countries really need is more inhabitants;

And what small countries need is some place

Where their surplus inhabitants can go and get employment.)

Thus each gets what it needs.

That is why I say the large kingdom must "get underneath".

position.

A small country conquers a great country by merging with it.

Thus, the great country conquers by yielding,

the small country conquers by being absorbed.

The great country needs more people.

The small country needs greater purpose.

Each gets what it needs.

It is proper for greatness to yield.

appropriate the great realm

And so the one submits, intending to appropriate

The other submits and gets taken in

(Where) the great realm has no greater ambition

than uniting & caring for others

(And) the small realm has no greater ambition

than joining & serving others

Then both of these each gets what it wants

if it is below the large state,

Then it is taken over by the large state.

Therefore some by being low take over,

And some by being low are taken over.

Therefore a large state merely desires

To unite and rear others;

While the small state desires

To enter and to serve others.

If both get what they want,

Then the large state should

Fittingly be underneath.

A small country can also win over a great country by practicing humility.

One wins by willingly taking the lower position. The other wins by willingly acknowledging its lower position.

The great country wants to embrace and nourish more people. The small country wants to ably serve its benefactor.

Both accomplish their ends by yielding.

Tao in the Universe is like the south-west corner in the house.

It is the treasure of the good man,

The support of the bad.

There is a traffic in speakers of fine words;

Persons of grave demeanour are accepted as gifts;

Even the bad let slip no opportunity to acquire them.

Therefore on the day of an Emperor's enthronement

Or at the installation of the three officers of State

Tao is the ground of the ten thousand things.

It is the refuge of the good man

and the guardian of the bad.

Fine speech can buy high rank.

Good deeds can earn respect.

Should one without them be abandoned?

Therefore, on the day the son is crowned

The way is a sanctum to the myriad beings

A good person's treasure

A less than good person's place of refuge

Elegant speeches may be useful at market

Noble deeds may be useful for promoting someone

(But if) another has less ability

Why waste what they are?

So (when) enthroning the heir to heaven

Sin

The Way is that toward which all things flow.

It is the treasure of the good man,

And that which protect the bad.

Beautiful words can be bought and sold;

Honored deeds can be presented to others as gifts;

Even with things that people regard as no good -

Will they be rejected?

Therefore when the Son of Heaven

Tao is the hidden secret source of all life. Good men recognize that Tao provides for them and therefore they esteem it. Bad men don't recognize this, but the Tao doesn't stop providing for them.

Beautiful words win some men honours; good deeds buy others acclaim. But the Tao values everyone, not just those who excel.

than send a team of four horses, preceded by a disc of jade,

Better were it, as can be done without moving from one's seat,

To send this Tao.

For what did the ancients say of this Tao,

How did they prize it?

Did they not say of those that have it

"Pursuing, they shall catch; pursued, they shall escape?"

They thought it, indeed, most precious of all things under heaven.

and the three ministers named,

do not send gifts of jade and teams of horses.

Remain still and offer Tao.

Why has Tao been honored since ancient times?

"Seek and you will find; transgress and you will be forgiven."

Is this not the reason?

Above all else, observe Tao.

Though there be big jade platters in tribute

Drawn by teams of four horses

This is not as good as sitting still (and) offering this path

What purpose had the ancient ones in honoring this way?

Was it not claimed:

"To seek is to find

To claim error is to be forgiven?"

So (this) becomes precious to (all) under heaven

Though you might salute them with gifts of jade

Preceded by teams of four horses,

That is not so good as sitting still and offering this.

That is the reason why he ancients

valued this - what was it?

Did they not say,

Those who seek with this, will attain, And those who commit offenses with this, will escape?

Therefore, it is the most valued thing in the world.

What's the sense in discarding anyone?

Thus, on the day a new king is crowned or powerful ministers installed, while others rush forward with gifts and praises, just be still and offer Tao.

Why have sages prized Tao for so long? Because with Tao, he who seeks finds, and he who has flaws is forgiven. This is why it is the treasure of the world.

It acts without action, does without doing, Finds flavour in what is flavourless, Can make the small great and the few many, "Requites injuries with good deeds, Deals with the hard while it is still easy, With the great while it is still small." In the governance of empire everything difficult Must be dealt with while it is	Perform not-doing. Work without motive. Savor what has no flavor. Regard the small as great, the few as many. Repay injury with compassion. See simplicity in the complex. See greatness in small gestures. Confront the difficult	Act without acting Work without working Savor without tasting Greatness is ordinary, much is little Repay ill will with virtue Plan for the complicated while it is simple Develop the great while it is small The difficult tasks under heaven Always begin in simplicity The greatest tasks under heaven	Work Act without acting. Serve without concern for affairs. Find flavor in what has no flavor. Regard the small as large, and the few as many. And repay resentment with kindness. Plan for the difficult while it is easy; Act on the large when it is minute. The most difficult things in the world Begin as things that are easy.	Act by not acting, accomplish by not straining, understand by not knowing. Regard the humble as exalted and the exalted as humble. Remedy injury with tranquil repair. Meet the difficult while it is still easy; cross the universe one step at a time. Because
still easy, Everything great must be dealt with while it is still small. Therefore the Sage never has to deal with the great; And so achieves greatness. But again "Light assent inspires little confidence And 'many easies' means many a hard." Therefore the Sage knows too how to make the easy difficult, And by doing so avoid all difficulties!	while easy. Do great things in small increments. The sage does nothing great, but great things are accomplished. Easy promises are easily broken. Things taken lightly become difficult. The sage regards nothing lightly, therefore nothing is difficult.	as minutiae This is why wise ones never assume greatness And so can achieve such greatness Those who lightly promise will surely be less trusted Much ease is surely much difficulty This is why wise ones look for things to get complicated And so in the end have no complications at all	in the world Arise from the minute. Therefore the sage, to the end, Does not strive to do the great. Those who too lightly agree, Will necessarily be trusted by few; And those who regard many things as easy, Will necessarily end up with many difficulties. Therefore, the Sage always regards things as difficult, And as a result, in the end he has no difficulty.	the sage doesn't try anything too big, she's able to accomplish big things. Those who commit lightly seldom come through. Those who think everything is easy will find everything hard. The sage understands that everything is difficult, and thus in the end has no difficulties.

In the days of old those who practiced Tao with success did not, By means of it, Enlighten the people, but on the contrary sought to make them ignorant. The more knowledge people have, the harder they are to rule. Those who seek to rule by giving knowledge Are like bandits preying on the land. Those who rule without	The ancient observers of Tao did not teach it to others. They let them remain simple and unknowing. People are difficult to deal with when they think they know. Leaders who think they know are a curse to those	Those ancients skilled at practicing the way Did not try to enlighten the people (But) would have tried to simplify them The difficulties of governing the people Are due to their great cleverness And so to use cleverness in governing a realm Is an injury to the realm To avoid using cleverness in governing	History Those who practiced Tao in antiquity, Did not use it to enlighten the people, Rather they used it, to make them dumb. Now the reason why people are difficult, Is because their knowledge. As a result, to use knowlledge to rule the state Is thievery of the state. To	In ancient times those who practiced Tao didn't want to enlighten people, but to keep them natural and simple. When cleverness and intellect abound, people don't do well. A leader who governs with cleverness cheats his people.
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giving knowledge Bring a stock of good fortune to the land. To have understood the difference between these who things Is to have a test and standard To be always able to apply this test and standard Is called the mysterious "power", so deep-penetrating, So far-reaching, That can follow things back —	they lead. Leaders with a simple heart are a blessing to all. Both are manifestations of the same truth. Knowing the truth is Virtue. Virtue is mysterious, profound, far reaching. Reaching far, it returns to itself and is complete.	a realm Is a favor to the realm Those who comprehend both of these Also examine for patterns Always to know to look for patterns May be called a mystic power A mystic power so deep & so far reaching (As) to help creation to turn itself around Natural succession then reaches perfect harmony	use ignorance to rule the state Is kindness to the state. One who constantly understands these two, Also understands the principle. To constantly understand the principle - This is called Profound Virtue. Profound Virtue is deep, is far-reaching, And together with things it returns. Thus we arrive at the Great Accord.	A leader who governs with simplicity is a blessing to his people. These are the two alternatives. Understanding them is subtle insight. The use of subtle insight brings all things back into the oneness.
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How did the great rivers and seas get their kingship
Over the hundred lesser streams?
Through the merit of being lower than they;
That was how they got their kingship.
Therefore the Sage
In order to be above the people
Must speak as though he were lower than the people.
In order to guide them
He must put himself behind them.

Rivers rule valleys and seas rule rivers
because they take the lower position.
The sage is elevated by placing himself below others.
He leads by leaving himself behind.
When he assumes high position,

What is the reason why the rivers and ocean
can serve as sovereign to the hundred valleys?
Because they are so well below them
In this way (they) can act as sovereign
to the hundred valleys
Applying this, in desiring to rise above the people,
Always in expression be subordinate to them
In desiring to go ahead of

Lead by following
The reason why rivers and oceans are able
to be the kings of the hundred valleys is
that they are good at being below them.
For this reason they are able to be the kings
of the hundred valleys.
Therefore in the Sage's desire to be above the people,
He must in his speech be below them.
if he would lead them, he must follow behind.
And in his desire to be

The sea is king of the valleys and streams because it is willing to be beneath them.

One who wishes to guide the people should be humble in her speech toward them.

the Sage be on top and the people not be crushed by his weight.
Only thus can he guide, and the people not be led into harm
Indeed in this way everything under heaven will into harm be pushed by him
And will not find his guidance irksome.
This he does by not striving;
And because he does not strive, none can contend with him.

the people do not feel his weight.
When he rules they do not feel threatened.
The realm rejoices and never tires of his presence.
Because he does not contend, nothing stands against him.

the people
Always regard yourself as behind them
This is how wise ones remain above
And yet the people are not burdened
Remain ahead
And yet the people are not obstructed
So it is that (all) under heaven readily come forward
and never weary
Because such as these will never contend

at the front of the people
He must in his person be behind them;
Thus he dwells above,
Yet the people do not regard him as heavy;
And he dwells in front,
Yet the people do not regard him as posing a threat.
The whole world delights in his praise
and never tires of him.
It is not because he is not contentious,
That as a result, no one in the world can contend with him.

One who wishes to lead the people must learn the art of following them.

The sage is above the people, but they don't feel her weight. She stays ahead of the people, and no harm comes to them. She has the affection of the whole world.

Because she contends with no one, no one can contend with her.

The best charioteers do not rush ahead; The best fighters do not make displays of wrath. The greatest conqueror wins without joining issue; The best user of men acts as though he	A good general is not aggressive. A good warrior is not wrathful. A skillful conqueror does not instigate battle. A skillful employer serves those under	The student skilled at action is not aggressive The one skilled at combat is not angry The one at besting opponents does not participate The one skilled at employing others	Using men Therefore, one who is good at being a warrior, Does not make a show of his might; One who is a good in battle does not get angry; One who is good at defeating the enemy Does not engage him.	A good general doesn't show off his power. a good warrior doesn't get angry. A good conqueror doesn't attack people.
were their inferior. This is called the power that comes of not contending, Is called the capacity to use men, The secret of being mated to heaven, to what was of old.	him. This is the virtue of not contending. This is mastering the strength of others. This is being in accord with the principles of heaven.	behaves as their subordinate This may be styled the "virtue of not contending" It may be styled "applying another's power" It may be styled "siding with heaven," The consummation of antiquity	And one who is good at using men Places himself below them. This is called the Virtue of not competing; This is called the ability to deal with people. This is called matching Heaven. It is the high point of the past.	A good employer puts himself below his employees. This is called the power of noncontention. This is called using the strength of others. This is called perfect emulation of heaven.

The strategists have the sayings: "When you doubt your ability to meet the enemy's attack, Take the offensive yourself" And "If you doubt your ability to advance an inch, then retreat a foot". This latter is what we call to march without moving, To roll the sleeve, but present no bare arm, The hand that seems to hold, yet	Skillful warriors have a saying: "Do not move first, play the guest. Do not move forward an inch, retreat a foot." This is called advancing without moving. Reaching without showing one's arms. Capturing without attacking.	Military strategists have a saying: "I will not dare to act as host, But rather, act as guest, Will not presume to advance an inch, But rather, retreat a foot" This may be called "to move without movement, To roll up sleeves without	Ambush Those who use weapons have a saying which goes: "I do not presume to act like the host but instead play the part of the guest; I do not advance and inch but would rather retreat a foot". This is called moving forward without appearing to move - Rolling up one's sleeves without showing one's arms -	In conflict it is better to be receptive than aggressive, better to retreat a foot than advance an inch. This is called moving ahead without advancing, capturing the enemy without attacking him. There is no greater misfortune than underestimating your opponent.
had no weapon in it, A host that can confront, yet presents no battle-front. Now the greatest of all calamities is to attack and find no enemy. I can have no enemy only at the price of losing my treasure. Therefore when armies are raised And issues joined it is he who does not delight in war that wins.	Doing battle without weapons. There is no greater mistake than underestimating the enemy. Underestimating the enemy, I risk losing everything of value. Thus, when equal opponents are matched, the one aware of sorrow will prevail.	barring arms, To depose without a fight To capture without force" There is no danger greater than underestimating a foe Underestimate a foe will risk losing what we value And so when opposing forces meet each other The one sympathetic will truly succeed	firmly, without holding a weapon - And enticing to fight when there is no opponent. Of disasters, there is no greater catastrophe Than thinking you have no rival. To think you have no rival, Is to come close to losing my treasures. Therefore when weapons are raised, and opponents are fairly well matched, Then is the one who feels grief that will win.	To underestimate your opponent is to forsake your three treasures. When opposing forces are engaged in conflict, the one who fights with sorrow will triumph.

My words are very easy to understand
And very easy to put into practice.
Yet no one under heaven understands them;
No one puts them into practice.
But my words have an ancestry, my deeds have a lord;
And it is precisely because men

What I teach is easy to understand and practice,
yet no one understands it or puts it to practice.
My words are from the source.
My actions are those of the ancestor.
People do not understand

My words are very easy to understand
Very easy to practice
(But) nobody in the world can understand
Nobody can practice
Expressions presume a lineage
Endeavors presume a master
Insofar as these

Individuality
My words are easy to understand
and easy to put in practice,
Yet no one in the world do understand them,
And no one put them into practice.
Now, my words have an ancestor.
And my deeds have a lord.
And it is

My words are very easy to understand, very easy to put into practice. But you can't "understand" them, can't put them into "practice."
Words have their ruler.

do not understand this
That they are unable to understand me.
Few then understand me, but it is upon this very fact my value depends.
It is indeed in this sense that "the Sage wears hair-cloth on top,
But carries jade under neath his dress."

this.
Therefore, they do not understand me.
Those who see me as I am are rare.
Those who seek to follow my teachings are few.
The sage wears coarse clothing
but carries jade in his pockets.

are unknown
So it is that we are not known
Those who know me are few
Accordingly I am valued
This is why wise ones wear common cloth
Concealing jade in the heart

simply because [people]
have no understanding [of them],
That they therefore do not understand me.
But when those who understand me are few;
Then I am of great value.
Therefore the sage wears coarse woolen cloth
But inside it, he holds on to jade.

Events have their origins. People who can't understand this can't understand me. Those who do are few.
They wear coarse cloth and carry jade in their breasts.

"To know when one does not know is best.

To think one knows when one does not know is a dire disease.

Only he who recognizes this disease as

To know that you do not know is clarity.

To think that you know is sickness.

To know without knowledge is best

To not understand knowledge is affliction

Now (it is) because afflictions afflict

That there is a

Sickness

To know that you do not know is best.

Not to know that you do not know is a sickness.

Moving from knowing to not knowing - this is good. Moving from not knowing to knowing - this is sickness.

a disease

Can cure himself of the disease.

The Sage's way of curing disease

Also consists in making people recognize their diseases as diseases

And thus ceasing to be diseased.

Being sick of sickness, one attains clarity.

The sage is sick of sickness.

Therefore, he is clear.

way to avoid affliction

Wise ones avoid disease

Because they are made ill by illness

This is the way to avoid the disease

Therefore the Sage is not sick.

The sage is not sick because he is sick of sickness.

Therefore, he is not sick.

You have to become sick of your sickness before you can get rid of it.

The sage isn't sick. He's sick of his sickness. Therefore he's not sick.

Never mind if the people are not intimidated by your authority.

A Mightier Authority will deal with them in the end.

Do not narrow their dwelling or harass their lives;

And for the very reason that you do

When people do not respect power, disaster is on the horizon.

Do not limit their space.

Do not disrupt their lives.

Do not oppress them and they will

(When) the people do not heed the imposing

Then great impositions come to pass

Do not constrict the places where they live

Do not overtax their means of living

Only when

Diplomacy

When the people do not respect those in power,

Then what they greatly fear, is about to arrive.

Do not narrow the size of the places in which they live;

Do not oppress them in their means of livelihood.

It is simply

If people fear your power, then you don't really have any.

Leave them alone in their homes.

not harass them,

They will cease to turn from you.

Therefore the Sage knows himself but does not show himself.

Knows his own value, but does not put himself on high.

Truly, he rejects that but takes this".

not tire of you.

The sage knows himself, but does not claim knowledge.

He loves himself, but does not feel important.

He lets go of that and chooses this.

there is no oppressing

Will there then be no oppression

This is how wise ones know themselves

Without displaying themselves

Love themselves

Without venerating themselves

And so dismiss That to choose This

because you do not oppress them,

That they therefore will not be fed up.

Therefore the sage knows himself but does not show himself;

He cherishes himself but does not value himself.

For this reason he lets go of that and chooses this.

Respect them in their lives, and they won't grow weary of you.

The sage knows herself, but doesn't dwell on herself; Loves herself, but no more than she loves everyone else. She adopts the concerns of heaven as her own.

He whose braveness lies in daring, slays. He whose braveness lies in not daring , gives life. Of these two, either may be profitable or unprofitable. But "Heaven hates what it hates; None can know the reason why". Wherefore the Sage, too, disallows it. For it is the way of Heaven not to strive	A courageous and reckless man will kill or be killed. A courageous and careful man preserves life. Of the two, which is beneficial and which brings harm? Who knows what heaven favors. Even the sage is unsure. The way	Courage atop presumption suggests dying Courage in avoiding presumption suggests survival (Yet) either of these may be sometimes beneficial, other times harmful That which heaven holds in contempt - Who knows as to the reasons? This is why wise ones watch for things	Fate If you are brave in being daring, You will be killed. If you are brave in not being daring, you will preserve life. With these two things, in one case there is profit, In the other there is harm. The things that Heaven hates - Who knows why? The Tao of Heaven is not to fight And	Those who are courageous out of daring are killed. Those who are courageous out of love survive. The first is harmful, the second beneficial. Heaven prohibits some things, but who knows the reason? Not even the sage knows the answer to this. This is the way of heaven: It doesn't contend, but easily overcomes.
but none the less to conquer, Not to speak, but none the less to get an answer, Not to beckon; yet things come to it of themselves. Heaven is like one who says little, yet none the less has laid his plans. Heaven's net is wide; Coarse are the meshes, yet nothing slips through.	of heaven does not contend, yet overcomes. Does not speak, yet converses. Without being summoned it comes of its own, unhurried, and according to plan. The net of heaven is vast. Though the mesh is wide, nothing slips through.	to get complicated Heaven's way does not compete, yet skillfully overcomes Does not speak, yet skillfully replies Does not summon, yet naturally attracts Is above all of this, yet skillfully arranges Heaven's net is vast & encompassing Loosely meshed, and yet nothing escapes	yet to be good at winning - Not to speak, and yet to respond with skills - Not to summon it, yet to let it come on its own - To be at ease and yet to plan with care. the Even age is unsure of this. Heaven's net casts wide. Though its meshes are coarse, nothing slips through.	It doesn't speak, but always responds. It can't be summoned, but comes of its own volition. Utterly without haste, it plans for everything. The net of heaven is vast. Though its meshes are wide, nothing slips through.

The people are not frightened of death. What then is the use of trying to intimidate them with the death-penalty? And even supposing people were generally frightened of death And did not regard it as an everyday thing, Which of us would dare to seize them and slay them? There	If people are not afraid of death, why threaten them with death? If people are in constant fear of death, and if being unruly means you will be killed, who would dare be unruly? Who would	(If) the people do not fear death Then why use death to intimidate them? Suppose it were so that the people always feared death And still they behaved perversely (When) we seized, detained and executed them Who would be bold? There will always be a master executioner to do	Tyranny If the people were constant in their behaviour and yet did not fear to die, How could you use execution to threaten them? If you brought it about that the people were constant in their behaviour en moreover feared to die, And we took those who behaved in abnormal ways and killed them - Who —	If people don't love life, they won't fear death, and threatening them with it won't work. If people have lives worth living, then the threat of death is meaningful, and they'll do what is right to avoid it.
is the Lord of Slaughter always ready for this task, And to do it in his stead is like thrusting oneself into the master-carpenter's place And doing his chipping for him. Now "he who tries to do the master-carpenter's chipping for him is lucky if he does not cut his hand."	dare kill him? There is always a lord of death. Trying to do his job is like taking the place of an artisan. He who tries to carve like a master carpenter rarely avoids being cut.	the killing Now to take the place of the master executioner & do the killing May be likened to taking the place of the master carpenter in hewing Now (of) those who take the place of the master carpenter in hewing Few indeed will not harm their own hands!	would dare act in this way? If the people are constant and moreover necessarily fear to die, Then we constantly have one in charge of executions. Now killing people in place of the one in charge of executions, This is like cutting wood in place of the master carpenter. And of those who cut wood in the place of the master carpenter, only few do not hurt their hands.	But killing itself should be the province of the great executioner alone. Trying to take his place and kill is like cutting wood in the place of the master carpenter: The odds are you'll hurt your own hand.

The people starve because those above them eat too much tax-grain.

That is the only reason why they starve.

The people are difficult to keep in order because those above them interfere.

That is the only reason why they are so difficult to keep in order.

The people

Why are the people starving?

The government takes their grain for taxes.

Therefore they are starving.

Why are the people rebellious?

The government interferes in their lives.

Therefore they are rebellious.

Why do people

The hunger of the people

Is from their superiors eating up so much of their tax grain

This is behind the hunger

The difficulties in governing the people

Are due to their superiors having to take action

This is

Extremis

The reason why people starve,

Is because they take so much in tax-grain.

Therefore the people are starving.

The reason why the common people cannot be ruled,

Is because their superiors have their reasons for acting.

Therefore they cannot be ruled.

What makes people go hungry? Rulers eating up all their money in taxes.

What makes people rebellious? Rulers who can't stop interfering.

attach no importance to death,

Because those above them are too grossly absorbed in the pursuit of life.

That is why they attach no importance to death.

And indeed, in that their hearts are so little set on life

They are superior to these who set store by life.

ignore the gravity of death?

They are consumed by the intensity of life.

Therefore they ignore the gravity of death.

One who is not consumed by life

is better off than one who values it.

behind the difficulties in government

The people come to take death lightly

Because they pursue life's riches

This is behind their taking death lightly

Only when one does not think life a performance

Will there be skill in valuing life

The reason why people take death lightly,

Is because they so avidly seek after life.

Therefore the people take death lightly.

Only those who do not act for the purpose of living -

Only those are superior to those who value life.

What makes people take death so lightly? People taking life too seriously. Those who enjoy life are wiser than those who employ life.

When he is born, man is soft and weak; In death he becomes stiff and hard. The ten thousand creatures and all plants And trees while they are alive are supple and soft, But when and dead they become brittle and dry. Truly, what is stiff and hard is	A man is born supple and soft. At death he is rigid and hard. The ten thousand things, the grass, the trees, while living are tender and pliant. In death they are dry and withered. The hard and unbending	People, while they live, are adaptable & soft When they are dead, are hard & stiff The myriad beings, the plants and the trees, while they live, are supple & delicate When they are dead, are weathered & tough And so the hard &	Flexability When people are born, they are supple and soft; When they die, they end up stretched and stiff; When the ten thousand things, grasses and trees are alive, They are supple and pliant; When they are death they are withered and dried out. Therefore we say that the firm and rigid	At birth a person is soft and yielding, at death stiff and hard. All beings, the grass, the trees: alive, soft, and yielding; dead, stiff, and hard. Therefore the hard and inflexible are friends of death.
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a "companion of death"; What is soft and weak is a "companion of life". Therefore "the weapon that is too hard will be broken, The tree that has the hardest wood will be cut down". Truly, the hard and mighty are cast down; The soft and weak set on high.	are companions of death. The soft and yielding are companions of life. Thus, an inflexible army is easily defeated. An unbending tree is easily broken. The hard and strong are laid low. The soft and yielding are raised up.	inflexible are companions to death The adaptable & soft are companions to life This is why the unbending military will not, in due course, be triumphant The rigid tree is then struck down The strong & great belong underneath The adaptable & soft belong above	are the companions of death, While the supple, the soft, the weak and the delicate are the companions of life. If a soldier is rigid, he will not win; If a tree is rigid, it will come to its end. Rigidity and power occupy the inferior position; Suppleness, softness, weakness and delicateness	The soft and yielding are friends of life. An unyielding army is destroyed. An unbending tree breaks. The hard must humble itself or be otherwise humbled. The soft will ultimately ascend.
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Heaven's way is like the bending of a bow.

When a bow is bent the top comes down and the bottom-end comes up.

So too does Heaven take away from those who have too much, And give to those that have not enough.

But if it is Heaven's way to take from those who have too much

And give to those who have not enough, this is far from being

The way of heaven, is it not like the stringing of a bow?

The high end is lowered, the low is raised up.

If the string is too long it is shortened. If the string is too short it is lengthened.

The way of heaven takes from the excessive and

Heaven has its path

Compare it to the drawing of a bow

What is high comes to be lowered

What is lowly comes to be raised

What has abundance will be diminished

What is incomplete will be added to

Heaven's way decreases where there is surplus

And adds to what is insufficient

Humanity's path is normally

Balance

The Tao of Heaven is like the bending of a bow.

The high it presses down, and the low it raises up.

To those with a surplus, it takes away; To those without enough, it adds on.

Therefore the way of Heaven

is to reduce the excessive and increase the insufficient;

The way of Man -

Is to reduce the insufficient

The way of heaven is like the bending of a bow. What is high up gets pulled down. What is low down gets pulled up.

Heaven takes from what has too much and gives to what doesn't have enough.

man's way.

He takes away from those that have not-enough in order

To make offering to those who already have too much.

One there is and one only, so rich that he the possessor of Tao.

(If, then, the Sage "though he controls does not lean,

And when he has achieved his aim does not linger",

It is because he does not wish to reveal himself as better than others.)

gives to the insufficient.

The way of man is different.

Those with too much take from those who have little.

Who keeps just enough and gives the rest to the world?

Only observers of Tao.

The sage works without expectation.

Achieves without taking credit.

He does not desire to seem worthy.

not like this,

Decreasing what is not enough

in order to give to what is excessive

Who can claim an abundance

in order to offer to nature?

Only those who keep the way

This is why wise ones develop but do not expect

Accomplish works but do not linger

They have no ambition to show merit

offer more to the excessive.

Now, who is able to have a surplus

And use it to offer to Heaven?

Clearly it is only the one who possesses Tao.

Therefore the Sage -

Takes action, but do not possess them;

Accomplishes his tasks - but does not dwell on them.

Like this, is his desire

Not to make a display of his worthiness.

Man is different: he takes from those who have too little and gives to those who have too much.

Who has a genuine abundance to give to the world? Only a person of Tao.

He acts without expectation, accomplishes without taking credit, and has no desire to display his merit.

Nothing under heaven is softer or more yielding than water;
But when it attacks things hard and resistant there is not one of them that can prevail.
For they can find no way of altering it.
That the yielding conquers the resistant
And the soft conquers the hard is a fact known by all men,
Yet

In all the world nothing is softer and weaker than water.
Yet for overcoming the hard and strong it is unequalled.
The pliant overcomes the unbending.
The submissive overcomes the unyielding.
Everyone knows this but no one puts it into

(In all) the world there is nothing as adaptable & soft as water
Yet of that which attacks the hard & inflexible
Nothing can surpass it
Because there is no way easier than this
The gentle finally overcomes the firm
The adaptable finally overcomes the persistent
There is no one under heaven
who

Accept responsibility
In the whole world nothing is softer and weaker than water.
And yet for attacking the solid and strong, nothing can beat it,
Because there is nothing that can replace it.
That water can defeat the strong -
That the weak can defeat the strong -
There is no one in the world that does not know it,
and yet there is no one who

Nothing under heaven is as soft and yielding as water.
Yet for attacking the hard and strong, nothing can compare with it.
The weak overcomes the strong. The soft overcomes the hard.

utilized by none.
Yet it is in reference to this that the Sage said
"Only he who has accepted the dirt of the country can be lord of its soil shrines;
Only he who takes upon himself the evils of the country
Can become a king among those what dwell under heaven."
Straight words seem crooked.

practice.
Therefore the sage says:
He who takes on the suffering of the world is fit to rule it.
One who accepts the evils of the world as his own
is a king under heaven.
Truth is often a paradox.

cannot comprehend (this)
(But) no one can practice (it)
So it is that wise ones maintain:
To accept the country's soil
May in truth be called mastering the altars of place & grain
To accept the realm's misfortunes
Is in truth to serve as sovereign to the world
Straightforward words may seem turned around

can put it into practice.
For this reason, the words of the Sage say:
To take on yourself the disgrace of the state -
This is called being the lord of earth and grain;
To assume responsibility for all ill-omened events in the state -
This is called being the king of the World.
Correct words seem to say the reverse

Everyone knows this, but none have the ability to practice it.
Therefore the sage says: One who accepts the dung of the nation becomes the master of soil and sustenance. One who deals with the evils of the nation becomes king under heaven. True words seem paradoxical.

(To requite injuries with good deeds.)

To allay the main discontent,

But only in a manner that will certainly produce further discontents can hardly be called successful.

Therefore the Sage behaves like the holder of the left-hand tally,

Who stays where he is and

When bitter quarrels are settled,

enmity is sure to remain.

What can be done?

A man of virtue pays his debts but does

(When) reconciling a great grievance

There will surely be lingering resentments

(And) how can this be regarded as good?

This is why wise ones will post the greater bond

And will

Reconciliation

To make peace where there has been great resentment,

There is bound to be resentment left over.

How could this be regarded as good?

Therefore the Sage holds The right tally

Yet makes no demands

In the reconciling of resentments, ill will often lingers. What's the good in that?

The person who is truly good concerns herself always

does not go round making claims on people.

For he who has the "power" of Tao is the Grand Almoner;

He who has not the "power" is the Grand Perquisitor.

"It is Heaven's way, without distinction of persons,

To keep the good perpetually supplied."

not exact his due.

He fulfills his obligations

but makes no demands.

The Tao of heaven plays no favorites.

It flows with Virtue.

not press upon others

To have character is to look after obligations

To lack character is to look for entitlements

Heaven's way has no favorites

But usually sides with the right person

of others.

For this reason, those who have virtue

are in charge of the tally;

Those without Virtue are in charge of the taxes.

The Tao of Heaven is impartial

It stays always with the good men.

with what she owes others, never with what they owe her.

The Tao of heaven is impartial. If you perpetuate it, it perpetuates you.

Given a small country with few inhabitants, He could bring it about that through There should be among the people contrivances requiring ten times, A hundred times less labour, they would not use them. He could bring it about that the people would be ready To lay down their lives and lay them down again in defence of their homes, Tather than emigrate. There might still be boats and carriage, But no one would go in them;	Let the state be small. Let the people be few. Though they have equipment to arm ten battalions they do not do it. They take death seriously and do not venture far. They have ships and carts but there is no place they want to go. They have armor and weapons but they are	Shrink the domain, spread out the people Let there be tens & hundreds of people with specialties But unemployed Let the people feel the weight of death And not wander far Though there be boats & wagons No place to ride them Though there be armor & weapons No reason to show them Let the people return to knotting —	Utopia Let the states be small and the people few - Bring it about that there are weapons for "tens" and "hundreds", Yet let no one use them; Have the people regard death gravely and put migrating far from their minds. Though they might have boats and carriages, no one will use them; Though they might have armor and weapons, no one will display them;	Let there be small countries with few people. Let the people have no use for complicated machinery. Let them be mindful of death so that they don't move too far from their birthplaces. If there be boats and carriages, let there be nowhere to take them to. If there are weapons, let there be no occasion to display them. Let the people's responsibilities be few enough that they may remember them by knotting a string.
But no one would drill with them. He could bring it about that "The people should have no use for any from of writing save knotted ropes, Should be contented with their food, pleased with their clothing, Satisfied with their homes, Should take pleasure in their rustic tasks. The next place might be so near at hand That one could one could hear the cocks crowing in it, the dogs barking; But the people would grow old and die without ever having been there".	not displayed. Men return to knotting rope. They enjoy their meals and are comfortable in their clothes. They are content in their homes and happy with their lives. Though the neighboring state is so close you can hear the cocks and dogs, they leave each other in peace as they grow old and die.	cords And counting on these (To) sweetening their own food Embroidering their own clothing Secure in their own homes Rejoicing in their own customs Neighboring realms overlook one another The sounds of each other's roosters and dogs are heard (Yet) the people grow old & die	Have the people return to the knotting cords And using them. They will relish their food, Regard their clothing as beautiful, Delight in their customs, And feel safe and secure in thir homes. Neighboring sates might overlook one another, And the sound of chickens and dogs might be overheard, Yet the people will arrive at old age and death with no comings and goings between them.	Let them enjoy their food, be content with their clothes, be satisfied with their homes, and take pleasure in their customs. Though the next country may be close enough to hear the barking of dogs and the crowing of its rooster, let the people grow old and die without feeling compelled to visit it.

True words are not fine-sounding; Fine-sounding words are not true. The good man does not prove by argument; The he who proves by argument is not good. True wisdom is different from much learning; Much learning means little wisdom. The Sage has no need to hoard; When his own last scrap	Truth is not eloquent. Eloquence is not truth. Wise men do not try to persuade. Whoever tries to persuade is not wise. One who knows, claims unknowing. One who claims knowledge, does not know. The sage does not	True words are not embellished Embellished words are not truthful To be right is not to be argumentative To be argumentative is not to be right To be knowing is not to be sophisticated To be sophisticated is not to be knowing Wise ones do not accumulate Though intending	The sage Sincere words are not showy. showy words are not sincere. Those who know are not "widely learned" Those who are "widely learned" do not know. The good do not have a lot. Those with a lot are not good. The sage accumulates nothing. Having used what he had for	True words aren't elaborate. Elaborate words aren't true. Good people don't argue. People who argue aren't good. People who know aren't full of facts. People who are full of facts don't know. The sage doesn't hoard.
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has been used up on behalf of others, Lo, he has more than before! When his own last scrap has been used up in giving to other, Lo, his stock is even greater than before! For heaven's way is to sharpen without cutting, And the Sage's way is to act without striving.	acquire. He bestows what he has on others and always has more. The more he gives, the greater his abundance. The way of heaven is to give without harm. The way of the sage is to serve without striving.	to act on behalf of another The more they themselves have gained Though intending to give to another The more they themselves are increased Heaven's way is to benefit, but without doing harm The wise ones' way is to work, but without competition © Bradford Hatcher, 2005 []	others, He has even more. Having given what he had to others, What he has is even greater. Therefore, the way of Heaven is to benefit and not te cause any harm; The way of Man is to act on behalf of others And not to compete with them. []	She increases her treasure by working for her fellow human beings. She increases her abundance by giving herself to them. The way of heaven: benefit all, harm none. The way of the sage: work for all, contend with none. []
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